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Part I

Our Father Course

Guide to Meditative Reading

Genesis, the Gospels, and the *Apocalypse* dominate the readings for the Our Father Course. Since those books (and there are others) are understood by Valentin Tomberg to be composed of spiritual exercises, he gives us some clues about how to read such books. Keep these points in mind as you do the meditative readings for day. In particular, in the *Meditations on the Tarot*, Tomberg explains how to read the Apocalypse as well as the Gospels. These techniques will apply to the other readings as well.

HOW TO READ THE APOCALYPSE: You may come to a different understanding from Tomberg's commentary on the Course. But this is how he suggests reading the Apocalypse:

the “key” to the *Apocalypse of St. John* is nowhere to be found... for it is not at all a matter of interpreting it with a view to extracting a philosophical, metaphysical or historical system. The key to the Apocalypse is to practise it, i.e., to make use of it as a book of spiritual exercises which awaken from sleep ever-deeper layers of consciousness.

The *seven letters to the churches*, the *seven seals of the sealed book*, the *seven trumpets* and the *seven vials* signify, all together, a

course of spiritual exercises composed of twenty-eight exercises. For as the *Apocalypse* is a revelation put into writing, it is necessary, in order to understand it, to establish in oneself a state of consciousness which is suited to receive revelations.

1. It is the state of concentration without effort (taught by the first Arcanum),
2. followed by a vigilant inner silence (taught by the second Arcanum),
3. which becomes an inspired activity of imagination and thought, where the conscious self acts together with superconsciousness (teaching of the third Arcanum).
4. Lastly, the conscious self halts its creative activity and contemplates — in letting pass in review — everything which preceded, with a view to summarising it (practical teaching of the fourth Arcanum).

The mastery of these four psychurgical operations, symbolised by “The Magician”, “The High Priestess”, “The Empress” and “The Emperor”, is the key to the *Apocalypse*. One will search in vain for another.

HOW TO READ THE GOSPELS: This requires the use of the imagination (step 3 above) to properly read the Gospels. This is so radically different from the scholarly techniques of textual analysis, etc., which mostly desiccate the texts.

The Gospels, likewise, are spiritual exercises, i.e., one has not only to read and re-read them, but also to plunge entirely into their element, to breathe their air, to Participate as an eye-witness, as it were, in the events described there — and all this not in a scrutinising way, but as an “admirer”, with ever-growing admiration.

THE HIGHER SELF: I recently listened to a super-correct theologian who objected to Hermetic teaching, calling the idea of raising one's state of consciousness "satanic". It is best to leave such types at peace, but, for us, we follow St Bonaventura, St Augustine, John Climacus, Dante, St John of the Cross, and many others who documented the ascent to God. I have documented their teachings on my blog; I do not create new doctrines. Tomberg uses traditional Hermetic terms to represent these higher states. Thomas Aquinas claimed we cannot know God in his essence in this life, yet we can go as far as we are capable of. This is how Tomberg describes it in the *Meditations on the Tarot*:

The transcendental Self is not God. It is in his image and after his likeness, according to the law of analogy or kinship, but it is not identical with God. There are still several degrees on the ladder of analogy which separate it from the summit of the ladder from God. These degrees which are higher than it are its "stars", or the ideals to which it aims. The Apocalypse specifies the number of them: there are twelve degrees higher than that of the consciousness of the human transcendental Self. It is necessary, therefore, in order to attain to the ONE God, to elevate oneself successively to degrees of consciousness of the nine spiritual hierarchies and the Holy Trinity.

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Daily Spiritual Exercises

As preparation for the Our Father course, please look at these daily exercises. There is an exercise for each day of the week. Spend 5 minutes in the morning with the exercise, and then throughout the day when it occurs to you.

MONDAY: RIGHT WORD. TALKING: Only what has sense and meaning should come from the lips of one striving for higher development. All talking for the sake of talking — to kill time — is in this sense harmful.

The usual kind of conversation, a disjointed medley of remarks, should be avoided. This does not mean shutting oneself off from intercourse with one's fellows; it is precisely then that talk should gradually be led to significance. Adopt a thoughtful attitude to every speech and answer, taking all aspects into account. Never talk without cause and be gladly silent. One tries not to talk too much or too little. First listen quietly; then reflect on what has been said.

TUESDAY: RIGHT DEED. EXTERNAL ACTIONS: These should not be disturbing for our fellowmen. Where an occasion calls for action out of one's inner being, deliberate carefully how one can best meet the occasion

— for the good of the whole, the lasting happiness of man, the eternal.

Where you do things of your own accord, out of your own initiative: consider most thoroughly beforehand the effect of your actions.

WEDNESDAY: RIGHT STANDPOINT. THE ORDERING OF LIFE: Live in accordance with Nature and Spirit. Do not be swamped by the external trivialities of life. Avoid all that brings unrest and haste into life. Hurry over nothing, but also do not be indolent. Look on life as a means for working towards higher development and to behave accordingly.

THURSDAY: RIGHT HABIT. HUMAN ENDEAVOUR: Take care to do nothing that lies beyond your powers. But also leave nothing undone which lies within them.

Look beyond the everyday, the momentary, and set yourself aims and ideals connected with the highest duties of a human being. For instance, in the sense of the prescribed exercises, try to develop yourself so that afterwards you may be able all the more to help and advise your fellowmen, though perhaps not in the immediate future.

This can be summed up as: Let all the foregoing exercises become a habit.

FRIDAY. RIGHT MEMORY: Remember what has been learnt from experiences. Endeavour to learn as much as possible from life.

Nothing goes by us without giving us a chance to gain experiences that are useful for life. If you have done something wrongly or imperfectly, that becomes a motive for doing it rightly or more perfectly, later on.

If you see others doing something, observe them with the like end in view (yet not coldly or heartlessly). And do nothing without looking back to past experiences which can be of assistance in your decisions and achievements.

You can learn from everyone, even from children if you are attentive.

SATURDAY. RIGHT OPINION: Pay attention to your ideas.

Think only significant thoughts. Learn little by little to separate in your thoughts the essential from the nonessential, the eternal from the

transitory, truth from mere opinion.

While listening to the talk of others, try to become quite still inwardly, foregoing all assent, and still more, all unfavourable judgments (criticism, rejection), even in your thoughts and feelings.

SUNDAY. RIGHT JUDGMENT: On even the most insignificant matter, judge only after fully reasoned deliberation. All unthinking behaviour, all meaningless actions, should be kept far away from the soul. You should always have well-weighed reasons for everything. And you should definitely abstain from doing anything for which there is no significant reason.

Once you are convinced of the rightness of a decision, hold fast to it, with inner steadfastness.

Right judgments are formed independently of sympathies and antipathies.

EVERY DAY. RIGHT EXAMINATION: Turn your gaze inwards from time to time, even if only for five minutes daily at the same time. In so doing you should sink down into yourself, carefully take counsel with yourself, test and form your principles of life, run through in thought your knowledge — or lack of it — weigh up your duties, think over the contents and true purpose of life, feel genuinely pained by your own errors and imperfections.

In a word: labour to discover the essential, the enduring, and earnestly aim at goals in accord with it: for instance, virtues to be acquired. Do not fall into the mistake of thinking that you have done something well, but strive ever further towards the highest standards.

- Turn your gaze inwards from time to time, even if only for five minutes daily.
- Sink down into yourself.
- Carefully take counsel with yourself.
- Test and form your principles of life.

- Run through in thought your knowledge — or lack of it
- Weigh up your duties.
- Think over the contents and true purpose of life.
- Feel genuinely pained by your own errors and imperfections.
- Labour to discover the essential, the enduring, and earnestly aim at goals in accord with it.

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Week 1: First reading

3.1 Day 1: Our Father who art in Heaven

READING: The Story of Paradise

The temptation in paradise was threefold, just as was the temptation of Jesus Christ in the wilderness. The following are the essential elements of the triple temptation in paradise, as it is described in the account of the Fall in the book of Genesis (from *Meditations on the Tarot*):

1. Eve *listened* to the voice of the serpent;
2. She “*saw* that the tree was good for food, and that it was a delight to the eyes” (Genesis 3:6);
3. She “*took* of its fruit and ate; and she also gave some to her husband, and he ate” (Genesis 3:6).

Now the serpent was more subtle than any of the beasts of the earth which the Lord God had made. And he said to the woman: Why hath God

commanded you, that you should not eat of every tree of paradise?

And the woman answered him, saying: Of the fruit of the trees that are in paradise we do eat:

But of the fruit of the tree which is in the midst of paradise, God hath commanded us that we should not eat; and that we should not touch it, lest perhaps we die.

And the serpent said to the woman: No, you shall not die the death.

For God doth know that in what day soever you shall eat thereof, your eyes shall be opened: and you shall be as Gods, knowing good and evil. And the woman saw that the tree was good to eat, and fair to the eyes, and delightful to behold: and she took of the fruit thereof, and did eat, and gave to her husband who did eat. And the eyes of them both were opened: and when they perceived themselves to be naked, they sewed together fig leaves, and made themselves aprons. And when they heard the voice of the Lord God walking in paradise at the afternoon air, Adam and his wife hid themselves from the face of the Lord God, amidst the trees of paradise.

And the Lord God called Adam, and said to him: Where art thou?

And he said: I heard thy voice in paradise; and I was afraid, because I was naked, and I hid myself.

And he said to him: And who hath told thee that thou wast naked, but that thou hast eaten of the tree whereof I commanded thee that thou shouldst not eat?

And Adam said: The woman, whom thou gavest me to be my companion, gave me of the tree, and I did eat.

And the Lord God said to the woman: Why hast thou done this? And she answered: The serpent deceived me, and I did eat.

And the Lord God said to the serpent: Because thou hast done this thing, thou art cursed among all cattle, and beasts of the earth: upon thy breast shalt thou go, and earth shalt thou eat all the days of thy life. I will put enmities between thee and the woman, and thy seed and her seed: she shall crush thy head, and thou shalt lie in wait for her heel.

To the woman also he said: I will multiply thy sorrows, and thy conceptions: in sorrow shalt thou bring forth children, and thou shalt be under thy husband's power, and he shall have dominion over thee.

And to Adam he said: Because

thou hast hearkened to the voice of thy wife, and hast eaten of the tree, whereof I commanded thee that thou shouldst not eat, cursed is the earth in thy work; with labour and toil shalt thou eat thereof all the days of thy life. Thorns and thistles shall it bring forth to thee; and thou shalt eat the herbs of the earth. In the sweat of thy face shalt

thou eat bread till thou return to the earth, out of which thou wast taken: for dust thou art, and into dust thou shalt return.

And Adam called the name of his wife Eve: because she was the mother of all the living.

Genesis 3:1-20

3.2 Day 2: Hallowed be thy name

READING: The Nine Beatitudes

It is said that, “Nature has a horror of emptiness” (horror vacui). The spiritual counter-truth here is that, “the Spirit has a horror of fullness”. It is necessary to create a natural emptiness —and this is what renunciation achieves— in order for the spiritual to manifest itself. The beatitudes of the Sermon on the Mount (Matthew v, 3-12) state this fundamental truth.

Meditations on the Tarot

1. Blessed are the poor in spirit: for theirs is the kingdom of heaven. (Mt 5:3, Lk 6:20)
2. Blessed are they that mourn: for they shall be comforted. (Mt 5:4, Lk 6:20)
3. Blessed are the meek: for they shall inherit the earth. (Mt 5:5, Lk 6:21)
4. Blessed are they which do hunger and thirst after righteousness: for they shall be filled. (Mt 5:6, Lk 6:21)

5. Blessed are the merciful: for they shall obtain mercy. (Mt 5:7.)
6. Blessed are the pure in heart: for they shall see God. (Mt 5:8)
7. Blessed are the peacemakers: for they shall be called the children of God. (Mt 5:9)
8. Blessed are they which are persecuted for righteousness' sake: for theirs is the kingdom of heaven. (Mt 5:20, Lk 6:20)
9. Blessed are ye, when men shall revile you, and persecute you, and shall say all manner of evil against you falsely, for my sake. Rejoice, and be exceeding glad: for great is your reward in heaven. (Mt 5:11-12, Lk 6:22-23)

3.3 Day 3: Thy Kingdom Come

READING: The seven stages of the Cross in John's Gospel.

Christian meditation pursues the aim of deepening the two divine revelations: holy scripture and the creation, but it does so above all with a view to awakening a more complete consciousness and appreciation of Jesus Christ's work of redemption. For this reason, it culminates in the contemplation of the seven stages of the Passion: the washing of the feet, the scourging, the crowning with the crown of thorns, the way of the cross, the crucifixion, the laying in the tomb, and the resurrection.

Meditations on the Tarot

MEDITATION: The seven stages of the Passion

- I. Washing of the Feet (Jn 13:1-20)

2. Scourging (Jn 18:22, Jn 19:1-3)
3. Crowning with Thorns (Jn 19:1-2)
4. Bearing of the Cross (Jn 19:16-17)
5. Crucifixion (Jn 19:18-19)
6. Laying in the Tomb (Jn 19:40-42)
7. Resurrection (Jn 20:1-18)

3.4 Day 4: Thy will be done on earth as it is in Heaven

MEDITATION: The last things.

- Mt 24:1-51
- Mt 25:1-46
- Mk 13: 1-37

Thus the first is also the last, and the “first day of creation” is the Last Day, the day of universal resurrection. Therefore the history of Christianity—moving in the direction of the Last Things, toward the future—is at the same time the history of the reawakening of the past, i.e., the resurrection of the total past, insofar as truth and love have dwelt therein. So gradually there will revive in Christendom the forgotten, deeply sleeping, and perished treasures of wisdom and sacrificial deeds of the past—right back to the primeval revelation and the paradisiacal state of humanity. Thus all truth and all love of all times will have their home in the Church of Christ, which will then be the all-embracing (catholic)

unity of all things and all beings who are striving for timeless values—in the sense of realizing the ideal of one Shepherd and one flock.

Covenant of the Heart

3.5 Day 5: Give us this day our daily bread

MEDITATION: Institution of the Last Supper

Christ's last words at the institution of the holy sacrament at the Last Supper: "Do this in memory of me" point towards the sacraments, too, as being a re-enlivening in the present of what happened in the past. In the holy sacrament at the altar, memory becomes an act of the divine magic of transubstantiation, an act relating to the real (not just remembered) presence of the body and blood of the Redeemer. What once took place, takes place now in the present. In the sacrament, memory does not become a journey into the past, but instead a making-present of the past, an evocation that summons something up out of the realm of forgetting, sleep, and death. Memory becomes the bearer of the power which sounded forth in the call of the Master — "Lazarus, come forth!" — a call that proved effective. Memory becomes divine magic, a miracle of great love and faith. In this sense the words: "Do this in memory of me" actually mean: "Do this, so that I may be present". For, one may add, the Son of Man is Lord over time too.

Covenant of the Heart

3.5.1 Imagination

Now as they were eating, Jesus took bread, and blessed, and broke it, and gave it to the disciples and said, "Take, eat; this is my body." And he took a cup, and when he had given thanks he gave it to them, saying, "Drink of it, all of you; for this is my blood of the covenant, which is poured out for many for the forgiveness of sins. I tell you I shall not drink again of this fruit of the vine until that day when I drink it new with you in my Father's kingdom."

Mt 26:26-29

And as they were eating, he took bread, and blessed, and broke it, and gave it to them, and said, "Take; this is my body." And he took a cup, and when he had given thanks he gave it to them, and they all drank of it. And he said to them, "This is my blood of the covenant, which is poured out for many. Truly, I say to you, I shall not

drink again of the fruit of the vine until that day when I drink it new in the kingdom of God."

Mk 14:22-25

And when the hour came, he sat at table, and the apostles with him. And he took bread, and when he had given thanks he broke it and gave it to them, saying, "This is my body which is given for you. Do this in remembrance of me." And likewise the cup after supper, saying, "This cup which is poured out for you is the new covenant in my blood. But behold the hand of him who betrays me is with me on the table. For the Son of man goes as it has been determined; but woe to that man by whom he is betrayed!" And they began to question one another, which of them it was that would do this.

Lk 22:14, 22:19-23

3.5.2 Inspiration

I am not speaking of you all; I know whom I have chosen; it is that the scripture may be fulfilled, 'He who ate my bread has lifted his heel against me.' I tell you this now, before it takes place, that when it does take place, you

may believe that I am he. Truly, truly, I say to you, he who receives any one whom I send receives me; and he who receives me receives him who sent me." When Jesus had thus spoken, he was troubled in spirit, and testified, "Truly,

truly, I say to you, one of you will betray me.” The disciples looked at one another, uncertain of whom he spoke. One of his disciples, whom Jesus loved, was lying close to the breast of Jesus; so Simon Peter beckoned to him and said, “Tell us who it is of whom he speaks.” So lying thus, close to the breast of Jesus, he said to him, “Lord, who is it?” Jesus answered, “It is he to whom I shall give this morsel when I have dipped it.” So when he had dipped the morsel, he gave it to Judas, the

son of Simon Iscariot. Then after the morsel, Satan entered into him. Jesus said to him, “What you are going to do, do quickly.” Now no one at the table knew why he said this to him. Some thought that, because Judas had the money box, Jesus was telling him, “Buy what we need for the feast”; or, that he should give something to the poor. So, after receiving the morsel, he immediately went out; and it was night.

JN 13:18-30

3.5.3 The 3rd Temptation of Jesus: Turning stones into bread

Then Jesus was led up by the Spirit into the wilderness to be tempted by the devil. And he fasted forty days and forty nights, and afterward he was hungry. And the tempter came and said to him, “If you are the Son of God, command these stones to become loaves of bread.” But he answered, “It is written, ‘Man shall not live by bread alone, but by every word that proceeds from the mouth of God.’”

Mt 4:1-4

3.6 Day 6: Forgive us our trespasses as we forgive those who trespass against us

MEDITATION: The seven miracles in John’s Gospel

The Gospel is proclaimed to us in events, signs, parables, and teachings. Thereby the events are simultaneously signs, parables, and teachings. The signs, however, are also simultaneously events, parables, and teachings. The parables are also events, signs, and teachings; and the teachings are at the same time events, signs, and parables. Everything in the Gospel is event, sign, parable, and teaching, i.e., everything is fact, miracle, symbol, and revelation of the truth. The miracles of the Gospels are thus also facts — as well as symbols and revelations of truth.

Covenant of the Heart

1. Wedding at Cana (John 2:1-11)
2. Healing of nobleman's son (John 4:46-54)
3. Healing of sick man at pool of Bethesda (John 5:1-10)
4. Feeding of the five thousand (John 6:1-15)
5. Jesus walks on the water (John 6:16-21)
6. Healing of the man born blind (John 9:1-7)
7. Raising of Lazarus (John 11:1-44)

3.6.1 The 2nd Temptation of Jesus: Casting down from the pinnacle of the temple

Then the devil took him to the holy city, and set him on the pinnacle of the temple, and said to him, "If you are the Son of God, throw yourself down; for it is written, 'He will give his angels charge of you,' and 'On their hands they will bear you up, lest you strike your foot against a stone.'" Jesus said to him, "Again it is written, 'You shall not tempt the Lord your God.'" (Mt 4:5-7)

3.7 Day 7: And lead us not into temptation

Moses did not cross the Jordan, but crossed the threshold of death. His “promised land” lay on the other side of the threshold of death. The people of Israel prepared themselves for the future encounter with the expected Messiah in the promised land; Moses was granted this meeting in the disembodied state. It took place in the scene of the Transfiguration on Mt. Tabor in the accompaniment of Elijah. Peter, John, and, James were present as witnesses to this encounter.

Covenant of the Heart

Meditation:

- The transfiguration on Mount Tabor (Mt 17:1-9, Mk 9:2-28, Lk 9:28-36)
- Healing of the sick child (Lk 9:37-43)

3.7.1 The 1st Temptation of Jesus: All the kingdoms of the world

Again, the devil took him to a very high mountain, and showed him all the kingdoms of the world and the glory of them; and he said to him, “All these I will give you, if you will fall down and worship me.” Then Jesus said to him, “Begone, Satan! for it is written, ‘You shall worship the Lord your God and him only shall you serve.’” Then the devil left him, and behold, angels came and ministered to him. (Mt 4:8-11)

3.8 Day 8: But deliver us from Evil

The only Son of the eternal Father nailed to the cross for our sake — this is what is divinely impressed upon all open souls,

including the robber crucified to the right. This impression is unforgettable and inexpressible. It is the immediate breath of God which has inspired and still inspires thousands of martyrs, confessors of the faith, virgins and recluses.

Meditations on the Tarot. Letter IV: The Emperor

MEDITATION: The seven Words from the Cross

1. Father, into thy hands I commend my spirit. (Lk 23:46)
2. My God, my God, why hast thou forsaken me? (Mt 27:45-46, Mk 15:34)
3. I thirst! (Jn 19:28)
4. Verily I say unto thee, today shalt thou be with me in paradise. (Lk 23:43)
5. Father, forgive them; for they know not what they do. (Lk 23:34)
6. Woman, behold thy son! (Jn 19:26-27)
7. It is finished. (Jn 19:30)

READINGS:

3.8.1 Revelation 12:

And there appeared a great wonder in heaven; a woman clothed with the sun, and the moon under her feet, and upon her head a crown of twelve stars: And she being with child cried, travailing in birth, and pained to be delivered. And there appeared another wonder in heaven; and behold a great red dragon, having seven heads and ten horns, and seven crowns

upon his heads. And his tail drew the third part of the stars of heaven, and did cast them to the earth: and the dragon stood before the woman which was ready to be delivered, for to devour her child as soon as it was born. And she brought forth a man child, who was to rule all nations with a rod of iron: and her child was caught up unto God, and to his throne.

3.8.2 Revelation 13:

And I stood upon the sand of the sea, and saw a beast rise up out of the sea, having seven heads and ten horns, and upon his horns ten crowns, and upon his heads the name of blasphemy. And the beast which I saw was like unto a leopard, and his feet were as the feet of a bear, and his mouth as the mouth of a lion: and the dragon gave him his power, and his seat, and great authority. And I saw one of his heads as it were wounded to death; and his deadly wound was healed: and all the world wondered after the beast.

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Week 2: Our Father who art in Heaven

4.1 Day 1: First curse of the Father

READING: Gen 3: 1-24

Meditate on the connection between disobedience (verse 6) and the necessity of toil (verse 17).

So when the woman saw that the tree was good for food, and that it was a delight to the eyes, and that the tree was to be desired to make one wise, she took of its fruit and ate; and she also gave some to her husband, and he ate. (Genesis 3:6)

And to Adam he said: Because you have listened to the voice of your wife, and have eaten of the tree of which I commanded you, 'You shall not eat of it,' cursed is the ground because of you; in toil you shall eat of it all the days of your life. (Genesis 3:17)

The fruit of the Tree of Knowledge of Good and Evil has had a triple effect:

- Toil
- Suffering

- Death

Toil or work took the place of mystical union with God, which union (without effort) is the teaching of the first Arcanum of the Tarot, the Magician. The mystical spontaneity of the first Arcanum is that relationship between man and God which was before the Fall.

Meditations on the Tarot

FIRST PSYCHURGICAL OPERATION: Concentration without effort.

4.2 Day 2: Second curse of the Father

READING: Gen 3: 1-24

Meditate on the connection between the feeling of shame (verse 7) and the necessity of suffering (verse 16).

Then the eyes of both were opened, and they knew that they were naked; and they sewed fig leaves together and made themselves aprons. (Genesis 3:7)

To the woman he said, “I will greatly multiply your pain in childbearing; in pain you shall bring forth children, yet your desire shall be for your husband, and he shall rule over you.” (Genesis 3:16)

Suffering replaced the directly reflected revelation or gnosis, whose direct revelation is the teaching of the second Arcanum of the Tarot, the High Priestess. The gnosis of the second Arcanum is that consciousness which was before the Fall.

Meditations on the Tarot. Letter III: The Empress

SECOND PSYCHURGICAL OPERATION: Vigilant inner silence

4.3 Day 3: Third curse of the Father

READING: Gen 3:1-24

Meditate on the connection between the feeling of fear (verse 10) and the necessity of death (verses 19-24).

And he said, “I heard the sound of thee in the garden, and I was afraid, because I was naked; and I hid myself.” (Genesis 3:10)

You are dust, and to dust you shall return. Then the Lord God said, “Behold, the man has become like one of us, knowing good and evil; and now, lest he put forth his hand and take also of the tree of life, and eat, and live forever”— therefore the Lord God sent him forth from the garden of Eden, to till the ground from which he was taken. He drove out the man; and at the east of the garden of Eden he placed the cherubim, and a flaming sword which turned every way, to guard the way to the tree of life. (Genesis 3: 19-24)

Death entered into the domain of life or creative, sacred magic, which is the teaching of the third Arcanum of the Tarot, the Empress. For sacred magic is that life which was before the Fall.

Meditations on the Tarot. Letter III: The Empress

THIRD PSYCHURGICAL OPERATION: Inspired activity of imagination and thought.

4.4 Day 4: The spiritualization of toil

READING: Gen 3: 1-24

The spiritualization of toil in creative spiritual work and meditation. Through the Holy Spirit.

The Fall changed the destiny of humanity — so that mystical union became replaced by struggle or toil, gnosis by suffering, and sacred magic by death. This is why the formula announcing the “good news” that the effects of the Fall can be overcome and that the way of human evolution can return to that of mystical union instead of struggle, that immediately reflected revelation or gnosis can replace the teaching of the truth through suffering, and that sacred magic or transforming life can take the place of destructive death.

Meditations on the Tarot. Letter III: The Empress

4.5 Day 5: The transfiguration of suffering

READING: Gen 3: 1-24

The transfiguration in the soul of suffering by passing through purgatory. Through the Son.

Take the terms “limbo”, “purgatory” and “paradise” in their meaning as understood by analogy and you have a clear and precise formula for the working of the magic of the sacred pentagram of five wounds; it effects a change from the natural state (“limbo”) and from the state of human suffering (“purgatory”) to that of the blessedness of the divine state (“paradise”). The operation of the magic of the sacred pentagram of five wounds therefore consists in transforming the natural state into the human state and this latter into the divine state. This is the work of spiritual alchemy of the transformation from Nature (“limbo”), and from the Human (“purgatory”), into the Divine (“paradise”), according to the traditional threefold division — Nature, Man and God.

Meditations on the Tarot. Letter V: The Pope

Concerning the experience relating to “purgatory”, it comprises all purging of suffering —physical, psychic and spiritual. It is corporeal, moral and intellectual suffering which is our intermediate state between the experience of the natural innocence of “limbo” and the moments of heavenly joy when the rays of “paradise” reach us.

4.6 Day 6: The transformation of death

READING: Gen 3: 1-24

The transformation of death into the ideal of initiation. Through the Father.

Initiation is the Second Birth that Jesus revealed to Nicodemus.

The rebirth from Water and Spirit which the Master indicates to Nicodemus is the re-establishment of the state of consciousness prior to the Fall, where the Spirit was divine Breath and where this Breath was reflected by virginal Nature.

Meditations on the Tarot. Letter II: The High Priestess

Neither did death then play the role of liberating consciousness, through the destruction of the forms which enclose it, that it has played since the Fall. Instead of the destruction of forms, their continual transformation took place. This was operated by the perpetual action of life effecting the metamorphosis of forms, in conformity with changes in the consciousness using them. This perpetually liberating constructive action of life was—and still is—the function of sacred or divine magic. And it is this transforming function, opposed to the destructive function of death, that Moses’ Genesis designates by the symbol of the Tree of Life.

Meditations on the Tarot. Letter III: The Empress

4.7 Day 7: Meditation on the Trinity

Thine is the Kingdom, and the Power, and the Glory.

Then the righteous will shine like the sun in the kingdom of their Father. (Matthew 13:43)

- GLORY: The Rainbow is the imagination of the Holy Spirit.
- POWER: The radiant solar cross in the blue sky is the imagination of the Son.
- KINGDOM: Stars shining in the dark night sky, strewn with stars, the soul turning towards the Father, accompanied by the words: Our Father, who art in Heaven.

This is the rainbow of seven colours of the manifestation of “glory” or mastership and also the octave of the seven tones of revelation of the “name” or mission of the vanquisher of the three temptations. And this rainbow shone around the empty and somber place in the wilderness where the temptations took place.

Meditations on the Tarot. Letter VII: The Chariot

Posted on 2023-02-19 by Cologero

Week 3: Hallowed be thy name

MEDITATIONS: The nine Beatitudes: Mt 5:1-12, Lk 6:20-23

This verse will require two weeks. The beatitudes awaken the Christ impulse in the various centers of the human being.

The nine beatitudes are the nine activities of the Comforter, the Paraclete, and are oriented to the perfect human being of the future. That is, they relate to the spirit-imbued human being.

The Sermon on the Mount is not concerned merely with human beings preserving their true natures in the face of natural evolution, nor even with them simply obeying the divinely revealed law, but that, in accordance with their archetype — “the image and likeness of God” — they become as God. “Be ye perfect therefore even as thy Father in heaven is perfect.” This central statement from the Sermon on the Mount is a call to ascend from the kingdoms of nature and the human being to the kingdom of God.

Covenant of the Heart

Jesus based Baptized in complete emptiness in the Jordan.

Then cometh Jesus from Galilee to the Jordan, unto John, to be baptized by him. But John stayed him, saying: I ought to be baptized by thee, and comest thou to me? And Jesus answering, said to him: Suffer it to be so now. For so it becometh us to fulfill all justice. Then he suffered him. And Jesus being baptized, forthwith came out of the water: and lo, the heavens were opened to him: and he saw the Spirit of God descending as a dove, and coming upon him. And behold a voice from heaven, saying: This is my beloved Son, in whom I am well pleased.

MATTHEW 3:13-17

And it came to pass, in those days, Jesus came from Nazareth of Galilee, and was baptized by John in the Jordan. And forthwith coming up out of the water, he saw the heavens opened, and the Spirit as a dove descending, and remaining on him. And there came a voice from heaven: Thou art my beloved Son; in thee I am well pleased.

MARK 1:9-11

Now it came to pass, when all the people were baptized, that Jesus also being baptized and praying, heaven was opened; And the Holy Ghost descended in a bodily shape, as a dove upon him; and a voice came from heaven: Thou art my beloved Son; in thee I am well pleased.

LUKE 3:21-22

The next day, John saw Jesus coming to him, and he saith: Behold the Lamb of God, behold him who taketh away the sin of the world. This is he, of whom I said: After me there cometh a man, who is preferred before me: because he was before me. And

I knew him not, but that he may be made manifest in Israel, therefore am I come baptizing with water. And John gave testimony, saying: I saw the Spirit coming down, as a dove from heaven, and he remained upon him. And I knew him not; but he who sent me to baptize with water, said to me: He upon whom thou shalt see the Spirit descending, and remaining upon him, he it is that baptizeth with the Holy Ghost. And I saw, and I gave testimony, that this is the Son of God.

JOHN 1:29-34

5.1 Day 1: First Beatitude: emptying the head

Blessed are the poor in spirit, for theirs is the kingdom of heaven. (Mt 5:3, Lk 6:20)

Alternatively, Blessed are the beggars for spirit, for theirs is the kingdom of heaven.

In his Baptism in the Jordan, Jesus had become empty and the greatest beggar for spirit.

The first beatitude means to say that those who are rich in spirit, who are filled with the “spiritual kingdom of man”, have no room for the “kingdom of heaven”. Revelation presupposes emptiness — space put at its disposal — in order to manifest itself. This is why it is necessary to renounce personal opinion in order to receive the revelation of the truth, personal action in order to become an agent for sacred magic, the way (or method) of personal development in order to be guided by the Master of ways, and one’s personally chosen mission in order to be charged with a mission from above.

Meditations on the Tarot

As a fact the wandering in the desert was an historical occurrence, as a symbol it is an expression of the timeless law of the necessity of purification and the “emptying of consciousness” as precondition for the revelation of God in His truth.

the first Beatitude of the Sermon on the Mount proclaims: “Blessed are the poor in spirit for theirs is the kingdom of heaven,” i.e., blessed are those who regard as poor any knowledge of power without God—that is, any knowledge or power not of God himself—for they shall participate in the divine archetypal creative work of God.

Covenant of the Heart

5.2 Day 2: Second Beatitude: courage of the heart

Blessed are they that mourn, for they shall be comforted. (Mt 5:4, Lk 6:21)

The blessing of Mary is contained in this; the inspiration that comes from suffering (“And a sword shall pierce thy heart”). The courage to endure suffering.

They that mourn or bear sorrow neither strive after a pain-free existence nor turn away from pain, but bear it with acceptance. For the fullness of existence, life’s true richness, does not consist solely in health and happiness but in an ever-expanding range of joy and sorrow; and the broader the range, the richer life becomes.

Covenant of the Heart

5.3 Day 3: Third Beatitude: control of the will, mindfulness

Blessed are the meek for they shall inherit the earth. (Mt 5:5, Lk 6:21)

Behold the course of one's life with inner calm.

Natural evolution rests on the principle that dominion over the kingdom of nature—over the earth—belongs to those with the greatest will to power. It is predestined for the tough and the toughest ... Not the tough but the meek shall rule earth's natural kingdoms. The power that St. Francis of Assisi, for instance, wielded over birds and fish and wild wolves was not of a kind that any natural scientist, fisherman, forester, or hunter has ever possessed. The same is true of the obedience rendered toward St. Anthony by the hyenas in the Egyptian desert, as well as of many other instances of deference from the side of so-called dumb nature toward truly meek humans ... That Christianity prevailed in ancient times despite its persecution is an instance on a global scale—one that cannot simply be explained away—where meekness took possession of the “earthly kingdom” (*orbis terrarum*) of that time.

Covenant of the Heart

MEDITATION:

And behold an angel of the Lord stood by them, and the brightness of God shone round about them; and they feared with a great fear. And the angel said to them: Fear not; for, behold, I bring you good tidings of great joy, that shall be to all the people: For, this day, is born to you a Saviour, who is Christ the Lord, in the city of David. And this shall be a sign unto you. You shall find the infant wrapped in swaddling clothes, and laid in a manger. And suddenly there was with the angel a multitude

of the heavenly army, praising God, and saying: **Glory to God in the highest; and on earth peace to men of good will.** And it came to pass, after the angels departed from them into heaven, the shepherds said one to another: Let us go over to Bethlehem, and let us see this word that is come to pass, which the Lord hath shewed to us. (Luke 2:9-15)

Glory (head) – Peace (heart) – Good Will (will)

Vladimir Solovyov, in his *Lectures on Divine Humanity*, wrote:

One can be considered free from passions only when one has them but has power over them, when one possesses, but is not possessed by them.

In Matthew, the word translated as “meek” is *praos*, which was also used to mean the gentling of a horse. The horse is the most noble of animals, but it must be broken to be of use to the knight.

So we see that the “meek” are those whose souls are under the control and guidance of the Intellect, or Head, since the appetitive and incensive aspects of the soul (the Will) have been broken and put in service to the highest aspect in man. They still retain their driving forces: the appetitive to achieve a goal, and the incensive to provide the emotional energy and motivation to persist. Far from being mousy or timid, the meek are strong willed and inner directed. This is why they shall inherit the earth.

5.4 Day 4: Fourth Beatitude: Christ impulse in the Sentient Soul

Blessed are they that hunger and thirst after justice: for they shall have their fill. (Mt 5:6, Lk 6:21)

Emptied head ⇒ Courageous Heart ⇒ Mindfulness in the Will ⇒ righteousness

The law of righteousness of the “kingdom of God” as expressed in the Sermon on the Mount ... is operative in the highest and most essential region of all. It heals the wounds of the heart suffered at the hand of injustice and transforms the pain of unjustly inflicted suffering into everlasting bliss. At the same time, without inflicting punishment, it leaves offenders to the tribunal of their own conscience—that is, to their karma. Thus, does the righteousness of the kingdom of God transcend both righteousness of retribution and that of atonement (karma) in that it is a bountiful and merciful righteousness. It bestows gifts of eternal value in whose light the shadows cast through suffering injustice disappear.

Covenant of the Heart

5.5 Day 5: Fifth Beatitude: Christ impulse in the Intellectual Soul

Blessed are the merciful: for they shall obtain mercy. (Mt 5:7)

Mercy is justice combined with love. It is judgment and at the same time creation of the means whereby the guilty can atone for their guilt, carrying not only the past and the present, but also the future.

All those who desire—that is, actually make the effort—to practice a morality transcending retribution and atonement will have their place in the kingdom of God and his righteousness ... It is thus not the will for the good favor and benefaction of merciful righteousness that makes one a partaker thereof, but the will for the kingdom of God and his righteousness in itself—will that is put into actual practice.

Covenant of the Heart

Through the sentient soul man is related to the animal. In animals, also, we observe the presence of sensations, impulses, instincts and passions. But the animal obeys these immediately. They do not, in its case, become interwoven with independent thoughts, transcending the immediate experiences. This is also the case to a certain extent with undeveloped human beings. *The mere sentient soul is therefore different from the evolved higher member of the soul which brings thinking into its service. This soul that is served by thought will be termed the intellectual soul*¹. ... The intellectual soul permeates the sentient soul. Whoever has the organ for “seeing” the soul sees, therefore, the intellectual soul as a separate entity, in relation to the mere sentient soul.

5.6 Day 6: Sixth Beatitude: Christ impulse in Consciousness

Blessed are the pure of heart: for they shall see God. (Mt 5:8)

This is the quality of deepened and extended mercifulness. With radiant heart, behold nature with a gaze that asks what nature needs. The healing gaze into the world is the pure heart; then one beholds God who is otherwise missing in the natural world.

Purity of heart is to will one thing. This is the return to the Primordial State before the Fall, i.e., before Adam and Eve listened to two competing, incompatible voices.

Duality therefore signifies the establishment of two centers of contemplation, two separate and rival principles —one real and the other apparent —and this is the origin of evil, which is only illegitimate twofoldness.

¹The Intellectual Soul is also called the Rational Soul. (e.g., Thomas Aquinas, Aristotle)

Meditations on the Tarot. Letter II: The High Priestess

5.7 Day 7: Seventh Beatitude: Christ impulse in the Self

Blessed are the peacemakers: for they shall be called children of God. (Mt 5:9)

The quality of the third beatitude, gentleness, is directed outward in the seventh beatitude, engendering peace.

TEMPTATION: to see Christianity as a revelation given once and for all.

[The peacemakers are those] who refuse to take sides in the face of partial truths and prejudices, being dedicated to the cause of the whole truth which unites the world and bears peace to it.

Meditations on the Tarot. Letter IX: The Hermit

The path of transformed evolution, in the case of individual human beings and of humanity as a whole, begins with a purification of the impulses, instincts, habits, and customs attached to natural evolution. Then it leads on to illumination—intuition of the truth, beauty, and goodness of divine evolution, the kingdom of God and his righteousness. Finally, it culminates in the union of will, feeling, and thought with the will, feeling, and thought that underlie divine evolution or the work of salvation.

Covenant of the Heart

Posted on 2023-02-27 by Cologero

Week 4: Hallowed be thy name (II)

6.1 Day 1: Eighth Beatitude: Christ impulse in the Manas

Blessed are they which are persecuted for righteousness'sake: for theirs is the kingdom of heaven. (Mt 5:10, Lk 6:20)

Turns suffering — the quality of the second Beatitude — into a creative activity.

The evil in nature is to be called forth out of the realm of dream into the waking world.

TEMPTATION: To proletarianize Christianity, making it exoteric and severed from the Mysteries.

Manas = ego consciousness or personal consciousness¹

The higher emotional center is to be found at the level of the heart, and the higher intellectual center at the level of the head. Their functions are different. In the Tradition they are sometimes

¹Cf. *Meditations on the Tarot*. Letter XXII: The Fool.

called the eyes of the Soul. Thus, St Isaac the Syrian said: “While the two eyes of the body see things in an identical way, the eyes of the Soul see differently: one contemplates the truth in images and symbols, the other face to face.”

Gnosis

Righteousness—that is, freedom and equality—remains an illusion when sought within the realm of natural evolution with its extension in human history. It is simply not to be found there—and never can be—because the “struggle for survival,” translated from natural evolution to the arena of human history, has nothing to do with righteousness. Righteousness must be looked for elsewhere, in another dimension ... The fact of their persecution for righteousness’ sake is manifestly something unrighteous that befalls them in earthly life, but the share in the kingdom of heaven they attain thereby reduces such unrighteousness to naught.

Covenant of the Heart

6.2 Day 2: Ninth Beatitude: Christ impulse in the Buddhi

Blessed are ye, when men shall revile you, and persecute you, and shall say all manner of evil against you falsely, for my sake. Rejoice, and be exceeding glad: for great is your reward in heaven: for so persecuted they the prophets which were before you.

MT 5:10-12, LK 6:22-23

The quality of the first Beatitude to become pure in spirit is creatively transformed: to be a representative of Christ on earth. One’s own personality counts for nothing.

MEDITATION: This beatitude exposes the evil of sub-nature, which was hidden in deep sleep. In the *Buddhi*, or higher intellectual center, the meditation is beyond images.

DANGER: to turn Christianity into a principle of domination.

Buddhi = consciousness of higher Self or cosmic consciousness².

The compensatory balance lies in the vertical earth-heaven axis and not along the horizontal axis of terrestrial events. It is the “reward in heaven” that illumines from above the unrighteousness endured in the current of evolution, driving it away like a shadow before the light. This compensatory balance, in the sense of vertical or divine righteousness, consists in the “reward in heaven,” that is, in the enrichment of humanity’s being and not in the punishment of the perpetrator of unrighteousness in accordance with the principle of horizontal justice: “An eye for an eye, a tooth for a tooth”

However, just as the law of karma morally surpasses both determinism and retributive justice, so it in turn is surpassed by the law of righteousness of the “kingdom of God” as expressed in the Sermon on the Mount. For the latter is operative in the highest and most essential region of all. It heals the wounds of the heart suffered at the hand of injustice and transforms the pain of unjustly inflicted suffering into everlasting bliss. At the same time, without inflicting punishment, it leaves offenders to the tribunal of their own conscience—that is, to their karma.

Covenant of the Heart

²Cf. *Meditations on the Tarot*. Letter XXII: The Fool.

6.3 Day 3: Authentic experience of the spiritual world

Human nature in ancient times was such that it was possible, without difficulty, to enable a man to partake in the happenings of the spiritual world. Today it is very arduous, relatively speaking, to undergo the true esoteric training leading to the attainment of clairvoyance.

RUDOLF STEINER, *Meditation on the Beatitudes in The Gospel of St. Matthew*. Lecture IX³

Rudolf Steiner has certainly said things of a nature to awaken the greatest creative elan! His series of **lectures on the four Gospels**, his lectures at Helsingfors and Dusseldorf on the celestial hierarchies — without mentioning his book on the inner work leading to initiation (*Knowledge of the Higher Worlds.*) — would alone suffice to inflame a deep and mature creative enthusiasm in every soul who aspires to authentic experience of the spiritual world.

Meditations on the Tarot

6.4 Day 4: The proclamation of the kingdom

The Sermon on the Mount was not simply about new doctrines. Nor is it merely symbolic. Rather, it is the spiritual activity of the Word. Specifically, it is not a matter of presenting new knowledge; it is supposed to change the level of being of those who hear it.

³<https://wn.rsarchive.org/Lectures/GA123/English/RSP1965/19100909p02.html>

The most important effect of the Sermon was a spiritual, suprasensory stimulation of the forces of the inner I, transcending the physical, etheric and astral bodies (vegetative and sensitive souls).

This transformation, entailing the conversion of natural evolution to the good, leads above all to the replacement of its guiding principle—the struggle for survival—by that of peace as the basis of the new evolution. For this reason, it is said in the Sermon on the Mount that the peacemakers are called “sons of God,” i.e., not only do they behold God but also take up his work, just as sons take up and continue the work of their fathers.

Covenant of the Heart

The Sermon on the Mount, considered a historical event of universal significance, marked a turning point of evolution after which the principle of peace is gradually coming to replace the principle of war. The path of transformed evolution, in the case of individual human beings and of humanity as a whole, begins with a purification of the impulses, instincts, habits, and customs attached to natural evolution. Then it leads on to illumination—intuition of the truth, beauty, and goodness of divine evolution, the kingdom of God and his righteousness. Finally, it culminates in the union of will, feeling, and thought with the will, feeling, and thought that underlie divine evolution or the work of salvation. St. Bonaventure characterized this path of purification (*purgatio*), illumination (*iluminatio*), and perfection (*perfectio*) in the simplest and clearest possible way (*De triplici via*, Prologus, I).

6.5 Day 5: The Beatitudes as the Seed of the Future of Humanity

MEDITATION: Follow the stages of Christ’s passion

First, our experiences with the three temptations in the desert.
Then, passing through the stages of the passion:

1. washing of the feet
2. scourging
3. crowning with thorns
4. carrying of the cross
5. crucifixion
6. entombment
7. resurrection

To be blessed does not mean an escape from suffering and pain, but the experience of a new kind of suffering and pain.

There will always be the fortunate and the unfortunate, but the blessed form a new class of human beings.

The fundamental conditions to be among the blessed: emptiness, inner poverty, and spiritual beggary.



Tomberg prefers the term “beggary” because the beggar knows he is spiritually poor.

Concentration exercise is on the Rose Cross in three stages:

1. Combine a series of images that evoke feelings into a single image and retained in consciousness.
2. Consciously wipe away that picture, so that the only thing remaining as an object of meditation is the soul’s own activity that built and held the picture.

3. Blot out this image-free content from awareness, leaving a perfectly empty consciousness.

6.6 Day 6: Knights of the Grail

The physical body is representative of the stage where a complete reconciliation between heaven and Earth could be brought about. There are three stages for the ego to unite:

- The ego is consciously united with the spirit
- The union includes the astral body
- The union goes beyond the etheric body to the physical body

High moral and spiritual truths can be learned through the experiences of the physical body. The physical body was seen as the communion body by those who understood the Grail tradition; it was the highest possibility of human communion with the spirit.

The search for the Grail testifies that there has always existed a striving for a conscious participation in the logic of the Logos, a quest for a Christian initiation.

Covenant of the Heart

St. Bernard advanced not only active contemplation for the monks but also contemplative activity for the knights — just as Krishna did more than fifteen centuries before him. The one and the other did so because they knew that man is at one and the same time a contemplative and an active being, that “faith without works is death”.

Meditations on the Tarot. Letter XIV: Temperance

6.7 Day 7: Guilt, Need, Care, Death

The life of an initiate must forever be veiled in mystery and is a secret between man's heart and his God.

COUNT GERMAIN

The path to poverty of spirit has four elements, taken from *Faust*:

1. GUILT. The experience of guilt.
2. NEED. The growing consciousness of what had been sacrificed and lost
3. CARE. The suggestions of a false future led to an awareness of care.
4. DEATH. Death as the gate into the world of real life, not as a gate to the realm of false existence

Initiation needs to be understood in the light of guilt, need, care, and death. These can only be experienced in the physical body. Some spiritual paths, e.g., Hinduism, had the goal of transcending the body in order to avoid the experiences of guilt, need, care, and death. Moreover, the darkness of the physical body comes with conflict with evil.

Without the experience of guilt, there is no experience of the need for redemption, i.e., the Christ impulse.

Meditate on these stages. This may lead to the realization of the intuition stage of the knowledge of the spiritual world, the goal of the First Beatitude.

Posted on 2023-03-05 by Cologero

Week 5: Thy Kingdom Come

The awakened will of the human being calls upon Christ for penance. The stages of the Passion are compensation for human guilt.

The Transgressions of man as prefiguration of Christ's sufferings in the passion:

Transgressions of Man	Stages of the passion
The Fall of man into sin	Washing of the feet
The curse against Eve	Scourging
The curse against Adam	Crowning with thorns
The fratricide between Cain and Abel	Carrying of the cross
Cain becomes homeless	Crucifixion
Redemption of sins through the Flood	Entombment
The experience of the end of the Flood	Resurrection

Christian meditation pursues the aim of deepening the two divine revelations: holy scripture and the creation, but it does so

above all with a view to awakening a more complete consciousness and appreciation of Jesus Christ's work of redemption. For this reason it culminates in the contemplation of the seven stages of the Passion: the washing of the feet, the scourging, the crowning with the crown of thorns, the way of the cross, the crucifixion, the laying in the tomb, and the resurrection.

Meditations on the Tarot. Letter XXI: The Fool

7.1 Day 1: First stage of the passion: Washing of the feet

The washing of the Feet is the *humiliation* through which the human being must pass because he submitted to the temptation "to be as gods".

True progress, true evolution, is the advance of beings from life under one law to life under another law, i.e., the structural change of beings. It is thus that the law "an eye for an eye, and a tooth for a tooth" is in the process of being gradually replaced by the law of forgiveness. It is thus again that the law "the weak serve the strong, the people serve the king, the disciple serves the master" will one day give way to the law shown by the Master through the act of the **Washing of the Feet**. According to this higher law, it is the strong who serve the weak, the king who serves the people, the master who serves the disciple — just as it is in heaven, where Angels serve human beings. Archangels serve Angels and men. Principalities serve Archangels, Angels and human beings, and so on. And God? He serves all beings without exception.

Meditations on the Tarot. Letter IX: The Hermit

Washing of the Feet (John 13:1-20)

Before the festival day of the pasch, Jesus knowing that his hour was come, that he should pass out of this world to the Father: having loved his own who were in the world, he loved them unto the end. And when supper was done, (the devil having now put into the heart of Judas Iscariot, the son of Simon, to betray him). Knowing that the Father had given him all things into his hands, and that he came from God, and goeth to God; He riseth from supper, and layeth aside his garments, and having taken a towel, girded himself. After that, he putteth water into a basin, and began to wash the feet of the disciples, and to wipe them with the towel wherewith he was girded. He cometh therefore to Simon Peter. And Peter saith to him: Lord, dost thou wash my feet?

Jesus answered, and said to him: What I do thou knowest not now; but thou shalt know hereafter. Peter saith to him: Thou shalt never wash my feet. Jesus answered him: If I wash thee not, thou shalt have no part with me. Simon Peter saith to him: Lord, not only my feet, but also my hands and my head. Jesus saith to him: He that is washed, needeth not but to wash his feet, but is clean wholly. And you are clean, but not all. For he knew who he was that would betray him; therefore he said: You are not all clean. Then after he had washed their feet, and taken his garments, being set down again, he said to them: Know you what I have done to you? You call me Master, and Lord; and you say well, for so I am. **If then I being your Lord and Master, have washed your feet; you also ought to wash one another's feet. For I have given you an example, that as I have done to you, so you do also.**

Amen, amen I say to you: The servant is not greater than his lord; neither is the apostle greater than he that sent him. If you know these things, you shall be blessed if you do them. I speak not of you all: I know whom I have chosen. But that the scripture may be fulfilled: He that eateth bread with me, shall lift up his heel against me. At present I tell you, before it come to pass: that when it shall come to pass, you may believe that I am he. Amen, amen I say to you, he that receiveth whomsoever I

send, receiveth me; and he that receiveth me, receiveth him that sent me.

Temptation in Paradise (Gen 3:1-12)

Now the serpent was more subtle than any of the beasts of the earth which the Lord God had made. And he said to the woman: Why hath God commanded you, that you should not eat of every tree of paradise? And the woman answered him, saying: Of the fruit of the trees that are in paradise we do eat: But of the fruit of the tree which is in the midst of paradise, God hath commanded us that we should not eat; and that we should not touch it, lest perhaps we die. **And the serpent said to the woman: No, you shall not die the death. For God doth know that in what day soever you shall eat thereof, your eyes shall be opened: and you shall be as Gods, knowing good and evil.**

And the woman saw that the tree was good to eat, and fair to the eyes, and delightful to behold: and she took of the fruit thereof, and did eat, and gave to her husband who did eat. And the eyes of them both were opened: and when they perceived themselves to be naked, they sewed together fig leaves, and made themselves aprons. And when they heard the voice of the Lord God walking in paradise at the afternoon air, Adam and his wife hid themselves from the face of the Lord God, amidst the trees of paradise. And the Lord God called Adam, and said to him: Where art thou? And he said: I heard thy voice in paradise; and I was afraid, because I was naked, and I hid myself. And he said to him: And who hath told thee that thou wast naked, but that thou hast eaten of the tree whereof I commanded thee that thou shouldst not eat? And Adam said: The woman, whom thou gavest me to be my companion, gave me of the tree, and I did eat.

7.2 Day 2: Second stage of the passion: The scourging

The scourging is to endure, to bear pain without resisting. The bearing of pain was handed to Eve as a curse.

Scourging (John 19:1); Striking on the check (John 18:22, John 19:3)

Then therefore, Pilate took Jesus, and scourged him.

When he had said these things, one of the servants standing by, gave Jesus a blow, saying: Answerest thou the high priest so?

They came to him, and said: Hail, king of the Jews; and they gave him blows.

The curse against Eve (Gen 3:16)

To the woman also he said: I will multiply thy sorrows, and thy conceptions: in sorrow shalt thou bring forth children, and thou shalt be under thy husband's power, and he shall have dominion over thee.

7.3 Day 3: Third stage of the passion: The crowning with thorns

Toilsome labor is Adam's curse. Earthly man must deal with thistles and thorns.

Every crown is essentially a crown of thorns. Not only is it heavy, but also it calls for a painful restraint with regard to the thought and free or arbitrary imagination of the personality. It certainly emits rays outwards, but these same rays become thorns for the personality within. They play the role of nails piercing and crucifying each thought or image of the personal imagination.

Meditations on the Tarot. Letter IV: The Emperor

Crowning with Thorns (John 19:2)

The soldiers plating a crown of thorns, put it upon his head; and they put on him a purple garment.

The “thorns” of the crown centre function as the “nails” of objectivity, which give conscience to thought. It is thanks to them that thought has not become wholly emancipated and as arbitrary, for example, as the imagination is. Thought as such is, in spite of all, the organ of truth, not of illusion.

Meditations on the Tarot. Letter V: The Pope

The curse on Adam (Gen 3:17-19)

And to Adam he said: Because thou hast hearkened to the voice of thy wife, and hast eaten of the tree, whereof I commanded thee that thou shouldst not eat, cursed is the earth in thy work; with labour and toil shalt thou eat thereof all the days of thy life. Thorns and thistles shall it bring forth to thee; and thou shalt eat the herbs of the earth. In the sweat of thy face shalt thou eat bread till thou return to the earth, out of which thou wast taken: for dust thou art, and into dust thou shalt return.

7.4 Day 4: Fourth stage of the passion: Carrying the cross

Humanity must pass through the carrying of the cross after Cain’s murder of Abel. Together they form a cross:

- **Abel.** The vertical stream, through the ascending and accepted sacrifice.
- **Cain.** The horizontal stream. He created the line extending in breadth.

The cause of all wars and revolutions — in a word, of all violence — is always the same: the negation of hierarchy. This cause is found already, germinally, at such a lofty level as that of the communal act of worship of the same God by two brothers — this is the staggering revelation of the story of Cain and Abel. And as murders, wars and revolutions continue, the story of Cain and Abel remains ever valid and relevant. Being always valid and relevant throughout the passage of centuries, this is a myth and, moreover, a myth of the first order.

Meditations on the Tarot. Letter I: The Magician

Carrying of the cross (John 19:17, Matthew 27:32, Mark 15:21, Luke 23:26)

And bearing his own cross, he went forth to that place which is called Calvary, but in Hebrew Golgotha. And going out, they found a man of Cyrene, named Simon: him they forced to take up his cross. And they forced one Simon a Cyrenian who passed by, coming out of the country, the father of Alexander and of Rufus, to take up his cross. And as they led him away, they laid hold of one Simon of Cyrene, coming from the country; and they laid the cross on him to carry after Jesus.

Cain and Abel (Genesis 4:1-10)

And Adam knew Eve his wife: who conceived and brought forth Cain, saying: I have gotten a man through God. And again she brought forth his brother Abel. And Abel was a shepherd, and Cain a husbandman. And it came to pass after many days, that Cain offered, of the fruits of the earth, gifts to the Lord. Abel also offered of the firstlings of his flock, and of their fat: and the Lord had respect to Abel, and to his offerings. But to Cain and his offerings he had no respect: and Cain was exceedingly angry, and his countenance fell. And the Lord said to him: Why art thou angry? and why is thy countenance fallen? If thou do well, shalt thou not receive? but if ill, shall not sin forthwith be present at the

door? but the lust thereof shall be under thee, and thou shalt have dominion over it. And Cain said to Abel his brother: Let us go forth abroad. And when they were in the field, Cain rose up against his brother Abel, and slew him. And the Lord said to Cain: Where is thy brother Abel? And he answered, I know not: am I my brother's keeper? And he said to him: What hast thou done? the voice of thy brother's blood crieth to me from the earth.

7.5 Day 5: Fifth stage of the passion: The crucifixion

The Crucifixion is (but not only) the state of belonging nowhere, neither in heaven nor on earth. Cain is the eternal wanderer. The two thieves are symbols of joining together of the two streams (vertical and horizontal).

The unconscious, instead of shocking intelligence, allies itself with it, penetrates it, and becomes luminous within it. But this takes place only after the more-or-less long and painful experience of the crucifixion of consciousness on the cross formed by the pair of opposites: subjectivity—objectivity (vertical), and the pair of opposites: intelligence—unconscious wisdom (horizontal).

Meditations on the Tarot. Letter XVIII: The Moon

The Crucifixion (John 19:17-22, Matthew 27:31-38, Mark 15:20-32, Luke 23:26-43)

In the times when the papacy was combined with worldly power the situation of inner crucifixion, and of “inner swooning” which it produces, was often too heavy a burden inwardly for individual popes, as human beings. Thus there arose attempts impossible though this might be at “flight from the cross”: into politics, court life, the enjoyment of art and culture, and the intoxications of sex.

Covenant of the Heart

And bearing his own cross, he went forth to that place which is called Calvary, but in Hebrew Golgotha. Where they crucified him, and with him two others, one on each side, and Jesus in the midst. And Pilate wrote a title also, and he put it upon the cross. And the writing was: JESUS OF NAZARETH, THE KING OF THE JEWS. This title therefore many of the Jews did read: because the place where Jesus was crucified was nigh to the city: and it was written in Hebrew, in Greek, and in Latin. Then the chief priests of the Jews said to Pilate: Write not, The King of the Jews; but that he said, I am the King of the Jews. Pilate answered: What I have written, I have written.

And after they had mocked him, they took off the cloak from him, and put on him his own garments, and led him away to crucify him. And going out, they found a man of Cyrene, named Simon: him they forced to take up his cross. And they came to the place that is called Golgotha, which is the place of Calvary. And they gave him wine to drink mingled with gall. And when he had tasted, he would not drink. And after they had crucified him, they divided his garments, casting lots; that it might be fulfilled which was spoken by the prophet, saying: They divided my garments among them; and upon my vesture they cast lots. And they sat and watched him. And they put over his head his cause written: THIS IS JESUS THE KING OF THE JEWS. Then were crucified with him two thieves: one on the right hand, and one on the left.

And after they had mocked him, they took off the purple from him, and put his own garments on him, and they led him out to crucify him. And they forced one Simon a Cyrenian who passed by, coming out of the country, the father of Alexander and of Rufus, to take up his cross. And they bring him into the place called Golgotha, which being interpreted is, The place of Calvary. And they gave him to drink wine mingled with myrrh; but he took it not. And crucifying him, they divided his garments, casting lots upon them, what every man should take. And it was the

third hour, and they crucified him. And the inscription of his cause was written over: THE KING OF THE JEWS. And with him they crucify two thieves; the one on his right hand, and the other on his left. And the scripture was fulfilled, which saith: And with the wicked he was reputed. And they that passed by blasphemed him, wagging their heads, and saying: Vah, thou that destroys the temple of God, and in three days builds it up again; Save thyself, coming down from the cross. In like manner also the chief priests mocking, said with the scribes one to another: He saved others; himself he cannot save. Let Christ the king of Israel come down now from the cross, that we may see and believe. And they that were crucified with him reviled him.

And as they led him away, they laid hold of one Simon of Cyrene, coming from the country; and they laid the cross on him to carry after Jesus. And there followed him a great multitude of people, and of women, who bewailed and lamented him. But Jesus turning to them, said: Daughters of Jerusalem, weep not over me; but weep for yourselves, and for your children. For behold, the days shall come, wherein they will say: Blessed are the barren, and the wombs that have not borne, and the paps that have not given suck.

Then shall they begin to say to the mountains: Fall upon us; and to the hills: Cover us. For if in the green wood they do these things, what shall be done in the dry? And there were also two other malefactors led with him to be put to death. And when they were come to the place which is called Calvary, they crucified him there; and the robbers, one on the right hand, and the other on the left. And Jesus said: Father, forgive them, for they know not what they do. But they, dividing his garments, cast lots. And the people stood beholding, and the rulers with them derided him, saying: He saved others; let him save himself, if he be Christ, the elect of God. And the soldiers also mocked him, coming to him, and offering him vinegar, and saying: If thou be the king of the Jews, save thyself. And there was also a superscription written over him in letters of Greek, and

Latin, and Hebrew: THIS IS THE KING OF THE JEWS. And one of those robbers who were hanged, blasphemed him, saying: If thou be Christ, save thyself and us. But the other answering, rebuked him, saying: Neither dost thou fear God, seeing thou art condemned under the same condemnation? And we indeed justly, for we receive the due reward of our deeds; but this man hath done no evil. And he said to Jesus: Lord, remember me when thou shalt come into thy kingdom. And Jesus said to him: Amen I say to thee, this day thou shalt be with me in paradise.

The curse on Cain (Genesis 4:8-16)

And Cain said to Abel his brother: Let us go forth abroad. And when they were in the field, Cain rose up against his brother Abel, and slew him. And the Lord said to Cain: Where is thy brother Abel? And he answered, I know not: am I my brother's keeper? And he said to him: What hast thou done? the voice of thy brother's blood cries to me from the earth. Now, therefore, cursed shalt thou be upon the earth, which hath opened her mouth and received the blood of thy brother at thy hand. When thou shalt till it, it shall not yield to thee its fruit: a fugitive and a vagabond shalt thou be upon the earth. And Cain said to the Lord: My iniquity is greater than that I may deserve pardon. Behold thou dost cast me out this day from the face of the earth, and I shall be hidden from thy face, and I shall be a vagabond and a fugitive on the earth: every one, therefore, that finds me, shall kill me. And the Lord said to him: No, it shall not be so: but whosoever shall kill Cain, shall be punished sevenfold. And the Lord set a mark upon Cain, that whosoever found him should not kill him. And Cain went out from the face of the Lord, and dwelt as a fugitive on the earth, at the east side of Eden.

7.6 Day 6: Sixth stage of the passion: Entombment

Noah protected all living things until there was again the possibility for new life. Then they re-emerged. Meditate on the image of the Ark.

Just as the Emerald Table saved the essence of ancient wisdom, and just as the Tarot saved the essence of mediaeval wisdom, across the deluges which occurred in the time that separates us from them, may the essence of modern wisdom be saved in a spiritual “**Noah’s ark**” from the deluge which is going to come, and may it thereby be transmitted to the future, just as the essence of ancient wisdom and that of mediaeval wisdom has been transmitted to us by means of the Emerald Table and the Major Arcana of the Tarot. The tradition of Hermeticism blossomed in the past and must live in the future.

Meditations on the Tarot. Letter XVII: The Star

Laying in the tomb (John 19:38-42, Matthew 27:57-61, Mark 15:42-47, Luke 23:50-56)

And after these things, Joseph of Arimathea (because he was a disciple of Jesus, but secretly for fear of the Jews) besought Pilate that he might take away the body of Jesus. And Pilate gave leave. He came therefore, and took the body of Jesus. And Nicodemus also came, (he who at the first came to Jesus by night,) bringing a mixture of myrrh and aloes, about an hundred pound weight. They took therefore the body of Jesus, and bound it in linen cloths, with the spices, as the manner of the Jews is to bury. Now there was in the place where he was crucified, a garden; and in the garden a new sepulchre, wherein no man yet had been laid. There, therefore, because of the parasceve of the Jews, they laid Jesus, because the sepulchre was nigh at hand.

And when it was evening, there came a certain rich man of Arimathea, named Joseph, who also himself was a disciple of Jesus. He went to Pilate, and asked the body of Jesus. Then Pilate commanded that the body should be delivered. And Joseph taking the body, wrapped it up in a clean linen cloth. And laid it in his own new monument, which he had hewed out in a rock. And he rolled a great stone to the door of the monument, and went his way. And there was there Mary Magdalen, and the other Mary sitting over against the sepulchre.

And when evening was now come, (because it was the Parasceve, that is, the day before the sabbath,) Joseph of Arimathea, a noble counsellor, who was also himself looking for the kingdom of God, came and went in boldly to Pilate, and begged the body of Jesus. But Pilate wondered that he should be already dead. And sending for the centurion, he asked him if he were already dead. And when he had understood it by the centurion, he gave the body to Joseph. And Joseph buying fine linen, and taking him down, wrapped him up in the fine linen, and laid him in a sepulchre which was hewed out of a rock. And he rolled a stone to the door of the sepulchre. And Mary Magdalen, and Mary the mother of Joseph, beheld where he was laid.

And behold there was a man named Joseph, who was a counsellor, a good and just man, (The same had not consented to their counsel and doings;) of Arimathea, a city of Judea; who also himself looked for the kingdom of God. This man went to Pilate, and begged the body of Jesus. And taking him down, he wrapped him in fine linen, and laid him in a sepulchre that was hewed in stone, wherein never yet any man had been laid. And it was the day of the Parasceve, and the sabbath drew on. And the women that were come with him from Galilee, following after, saw the sepulchre, and how his body was laid. And returning, they prepared spices and ointments; and on the sabbath day they rested, according to the commandment.

The Flood (Genesis 6:5-22, 7:1-23)

And God seeing that the wickedness of men was great on the earth, and that all the thought of their heart was bent upon evil at all times, It repented him that he had made man on the earth. And being touched inwardly with sorrow of heart, He said: I will destroy man, whom I have created, from the face of the earth, from man even to beasts, from the creeping thing even to the fowls of the air, for it repenteth me that I have made them. But Noah found grace before the Lord. These are the generations of Noah: Noah was a just and perfect man in his generations, he walked with God. And he begot three sons, Sem, Cham, and Japheth.

And the earth was corrupted before God, and was filled with iniquity. And when God had seen that the earth was corrupted (for all flesh had corrupted its way upon the earth,) He said to Noah: The end of all flesh is come before me, the earth is filled with iniquity through them, and I will destroy them with the earth. Make thee an ark of timber planks: thou shalt make little rooms in the ark, and thou shalt pitch it within and without. And thus shalt thou make it: The length of the ark shall be three hundred cubits: the breadth of it fifty cubits, and the height of it thirty cubits. Thou shalt make a window in the ark, and in a cubit shalt thou finish the top of it: and the door of the ark thou shalt set in the side: with lower, middle chambers, and third stories shalt thou make it. Behold I will bring the waters of a great flood upon the earth, to destroy all flesh, wherein is the breath of life, under heaven. All things that are in the earth shall be consumed. And I will establish my covenant with thee, and thou shalt enter into the ark, thou and thy sons, and thy wife, and the wives of thy sons with thee. And of every living creature of all flesh, thou shalt bring two of a sort into the ark, that they may live with thee: of the male sex, and the female. Of fowls according to their kind, and of beasts in their kind, and of every thing that creepeth on the earth according to its kind; two of every sort shall go in with thee, that they may live. Thou shalt take unto thee of all food that may be eaten, and thou shalt lay it up with thee: and it shall be food for thee and them. And Noah did all

things which God commanded him.

And the Lord said to him: Go in thou and all thy house into the ark: for thee I have seen just before me in this generation. Of all clean beasts take seven and seven, the male and the female. But of the beasts that are unclean two and two, the male and the female. Of the fowls also of the air seven and seven, the male and the female: that seed may be saved upon the face of the whole earth. For yet a while, and after seven days, I will rain upon the earth forty days and forty nights; and I will destroy every substance that I have made, from the face of the earth. And Noah did all things which the Lord had commanded him. And he was six hundred years old, when the waters of the flood overflowed the earth. And Noah went in and his sons, his wife and the wives of his sons with him into the ark, because of the waters of the flood. And of beasts clean and unclean, and of fowls, and of every thing that moveth upon the earth, Two and two went in to Noe into the ark, male and female, as the Lord had commanded Noah.

And after the seven days were passed, the waters of the flood overflowed the earth. In the six hundredth year of the life of Noah, in the second month, in the seventeenth day of the month, all the fountains of the great deep were broken up, and the flood gates of heaven were opened: And the rain fell upon the earth forty days and forty nights. In the selfsame day Noah, and Shem, and Ham, and Japheth his sons: his wife, and the three wives of his sons with them, went into the ark: They and every beast according to its kind, and all the cattle in their kind, and every thing that moveth upon the earth according to its kind, and every fowl according to its kind, all birds, and all that fly, Went in to Noah into the ark, two and two of all flesh, wherein was the breath of life. And they that went in, went in male and female of all flesh, as God had commanded him: and the Lord shut him in on the outside.

And the flood was forty days upon the earth, and the waters increased, and lifted up the ark on high from the earth. For they overflowed exceed-

ingly: and filled all on the face of the earth: and the ark was carried upon the waters. And the waters prevailed beyond measure upon the earth: and all the high mountains under the whole heaven were covered. The water was fifteen cubits higher than the mountains which it covered. And all flesh was destroyed that moved upon the earth, both of fowl, and of cattle, and of beasts, and of all creeping things that creep upon the earth: and all men. And all things wherein there is the breath of life on the earth, died. And he destroyed all the substance that was upon the earth, from man even to beast, and the creeping things and fowls of the air: and they were destroyed from the earth: and Noe only remained, and they that were with him in the ark.

7.7 Day 7: Seventh stage of the passion: The resurrection

The seventh stage is the Resurrection which came when everything re-emerged from Noah. The rainbow is the symbol of reconciliation with God.

The concept, idea, and ideal of resurrection is different from the concept, idea, and ideal of eternal life, as a resting in God, where the soul returns to the “Father’s house” and remains there for all eternity. Resurrection is not merely the end of the old, but actually means the beginning of a new world-creation, with “a new heaven and a new earth”. It is not the soul’s rest in eternity, not the eternal rest of Nirvana, but an active cooperation with God in a renewed world, healed of the consequences of the Fall into sin. The “new Jerusalem” is a new world-order related to the old one in the same way as the resurrected man is related to mortal man. The resurrection may be conceived of as the reappearance and active participation of the total human being — as spirit, soul, and

body — in the domain of the “world-in-progress”. As an idea, the resurrection is the realisation that God is divinely generous, that he does not take away again what he has once given and granted, but that his gifts — existence, consciousness, freedom, and creative activity — are valid for all eternity.

Covenant of the Heart

The Resurrection (John 20:1-10, Matthew 28:1-10, Mark 16:1-11, Luke 24:1-12)

And on the first day of the week, Mary Magdalen cometh early, when it was yet dark, unto the sepulchre; and she saw the stone taken away from the sepulchre. She ran, therefore, and cometh to Simon Peter, and to the other disciple whom Jesus loved, and saith to them: They have taken away the Lord out of the sepulchre, and we know not where they have laid him. Peter therefore went out, and that other disciple, and they came to the sepulchre. And they both ran together, and that other disciple did outrun Peter, and came first to the sepulchre. And when he stooped down, he saw the linen cloths lying; but yet he went not in. Then cometh Simon Peter, following him, and went into the sepulchre, and saw the linen cloths lying, And the napkin that had been about his head, not lying with the linen cloths, but apart, wrapped up into one place. Then that other disciple also went in, who came first to the sepulchre: and he saw, and believed. For as yet they knew not the scripture, that he must rise again from the dead. The disciples therefore departed again to their home.

And in the end of the sabbath, when it began to dawn towards the first day of the week, came Mary Magdalen and the other Mary, to see the sepulchre. And behold there was a great earthquake. For an angel of the Lord descended from heaven, and coming, rolled back the stone, and sat upon it. And his countenance was as lightning, and his raiment as snow. And for fear of him, the guards were struck with terror, and became as

dead men. And the angel answering, said to the women: Fear not you; for I know that you seek Jesus who was crucified. He is not here, for he is risen, as he said. Come, and see the place where the Lord was laid. And going quickly, tell ye his disciples that he is risen: and behold he will go before you into Galilee; there you shall see him. Lo, I have foretold it to you. And they went out quickly from the sepulchre with fear and great joy, running to tell his disciples. And behold Jesus met them, saying: All hail. But they came up and took hold of his feet, and adored him. Then Jesus said to them: Fear not. Go, tell my brethren that they go into Galilee, there they shall see me.

And when the sabbath was past, Mary Magdalen, and Mary the mother of James, and Salome, bought sweet spices, that coming, they might anoint Jesus. And very early in the morning, the first day of the week, they come to the sepulchre, the sun being now risen. And they said one to another: Who shall roll us back the stone from the door of the sepulchre? And looking, they saw the stone rolled back. For it was very great. And entering into the sepulchre, they saw a young man sitting on the right side, clothed with a white robe: and they were astonished. Who saith to them: Be not affrighted; you seek Jesus of Nazareth, who was crucified: he is risen, he is not here, behold the place where they laid him. But go, tell his disciples and Peter that he goeth before you into Galilee; there you shall see him, as he told you. But they going out, fled from the sepulchre. For a trembling and fear had seized them: and they said nothing to any man; for they were afraid. But he rising early the first day of the week, appeared first to Mary Magdalen, out of whom he had cast seven devils. She went and told them that had been with him, who were mourning and weeping. And they hearing that he was alive, and had been seen by her, did not believe.

And on the first day of the week, very early in the morning, they came to the sepulchre, bringing the spices which they had prepared. And they found the stone rolled back from the sepulchre. And going in, they found

not the body of the Lord Jesus. And it came to pass, as they were astonished in their mind at this, behold, two men stood by them, in shining apparel. And as they were afraid, and bowed down their countenance towards the ground, they said unto them: Why seek you the living with the dead? He is not here, but is risen. Remember how he spoke unto you, when he was in Galilee, Saying: The Son of man must be delivered into the hands of sinful men, and be crucified, and the third day rise again. And they remembered his words. And going back from the sepulchre, they told all these things to the eleven, and to all the rest. And it was Mary Magdalen, and Joanna, and Mary of James, and the other women that were with them, who told these things to the apostles. And these words seemed to them as idle tales; and they did not believe them. But Peter rising up, ran to the sepulchre, and stooping down, he saw the linen cloths laid by themselves; and went away wondering in himself at that which was come to pass.

The End of the Flood (Genesis 8:24-33)

Therefore in the six hundredth and first year, the first month, the first day of the month, the waters were lessened upon the earth, and Noe opening the covering of the ark, looked, and saw that the face of the earth was dried. In the second month, the seven and twentieth day of the month, the earth was dried. And God spoke to Noah, saying:

Go out of the ark, thou and thy wife, thy sons, and the wives of thy sons with thee. All living things that are with thee of all flesh, as well in fowls as in beasts, and all creeping things that creep upon the earth, bring out with thee, and go ye upon the earth: increase and multiply upon it.

So Noah went out, he and his sons: his wife, and the wives of his sons with him. And all living things, and cattle, and creeping things that creep upon the earth, according to their kinds, went out of the ark. And Noah built an altar unto the Lord: and taking of all cattle and fowls that were clean, offered holocausts upon the altar. And the Lord smelled a sweet saviour, and said:

I will no more curse the earth for the sake of man: for the imagination and thought of man's heart are prone to evil from his youth: therefore I will no more destroy every living soul as I have done. All the days of the earth, seedtime and harvest, cold and heat, summer and winter, night and day, shall not cease.

The Rainbow, symbol of the reconciliation with God (Genesis 9:12-17)

And God said:

This is the sign of the covenant which I give between me and you, and to every living soul that is with you, for perpetual generations. I will set my bow in the clouds, and it shall be the sign of a covenant between me, and between the earth. And when I shall cover the sky with clouds, my bow shall appear in the clouds: And I will remember my covenant with you, and with every living soul that beareth flesh: and there shall no more be waters of a flood to destroy all flesh.

And the bow shall be in the clouds, and I shall see it, and shall remember the everlasting covenant, that was made between God and every living soul of all flesh which is upon the earth.

And God said to Noah: This shall be the sign of the covenant which I have established between me and all flesh upon the earth.

Posted on 2023-03-12 by Cologero

Week 6: Thy Will be done

Meditation on God's blessings and judgment.

Blessing	Judgment
The seeds in the Garden	The seeds of the Earth
Man shall not be alone	Cain must wander alone
The four rivers of the Garden	The Flood
Adam names the animals	The Tower of Babel: God confuses human language

8.1 Day 1: First blessing of God

The blessing of eating the seeds in the Garden, i.e., spiritual nourishment, changes into the curse of feeding on plant matter.

The third day of creation is the “day” of procreation, of the mystery of seed and of growth. The third day of creation is the generation of the seed principle, of the principle of potential formative force becoming actualized and bringing to visible realization its own inner, invisible shape. The third day of creation is the coming

into being of the seed principle in the world, that is, not only of the plant-world manifested to us as plants and trees, but also such “trees” growing in paradise as “the tree of knowledge of good and evil” and the “tree of life”.

Covenant of the Heart

MT 7:16-18: You will know them by their fruits. Are grapes gathered from thorns, or figs from thistles? So, every sound tree bears good fruit, but the bad tree bears evil fruit. A sound tree cannot bear evil fruit, nor can a bad tree bear good fruit.

First Blessing of God: Genesis 1:26-31

And he said: Let us make man to our image and likeness: and let him have dominion over the fishes of the sea, and the fowls of the air, and the beasts, and the whole earth, and every creeping creature that moveth upon the earth. And God created man to his own image: to the image of God he created him: male and female he created them. And God blessed them, saying: Increase and multiply, and fill the earth, and subdue it, and rule over the fishes of the sea, and the fowls of the air, and all living creatures that move upon the earth. And God said: Behold I have given you every herb bearing seed upon the earth, and all trees that have in themselves seed of their own kind, to be your meat: And to all beasts of the earth, and to every fowl of the air, and to all that move upon the earth, and wherein there is life, that they may have to feed upon. And it was so done. And God saw all the things that he had made, and they were very good. And the evening and morning were the sixth day.

First Judgment of God: Genesis 3:18

Thorns and thistles shall it bring forth to thee; and thou shalt eat the herbs of the earth.

8.2 Day 2: Second blessing of God

Revolt, possession, and substitution of the fabricated for the revealed — with these three sins there correspond three “falls” and effects entailed by them. Cain, who killed his brother Abel, became an exile — he became a wanderer.

Meditations on the Tarot. Letter XVI: The Tower of Destruction

Second Blessing of God: Genesis 1:27, 2:18-25

God gave the human being Adam another human being, Eve, so that man would not be alone.

He who finds silence in the solitude of concentration without effort, is never alone. He never bears alone the weights that he has to carry; the forces of heaven, the forces from on high, are there taking part from now on.

Meditations on the Tarot. Letter I: The Magician

Second Judgment of God: Genesis 4:1-16

Cain murders another human being, so Cain must wander alone again.

8.3 Day 3: Third blessing of God

In the world there are therefore two different kinds of arriving at a conviction: one can be illumined by the serene clarity of contemplation, or one can be swept away by an electrifying flood of passionate arguments aiming at a desired end. The faith of the illumined is full of tolerance, patience and calm steadfastness — like crystal; the faith of those who are swept away is, in contrast,

fanatical, agitated and aggressive — in order to live it needs conquests without end. because it is conquest alone which keeps it alive. The faith of those who are swept away is greedy for success, this being its reason for existence, its criterion and its motivating force.

Meditations on the Tarot. Letter XI: Force

Third Blessing of God: Genesis 2:4-17

God gave to the human being the Garden of Eden and its four rivers, or ether streams, as a dwelling place.

Such are the “trees” of the garden that we cultivate and maintain, i.e., the mysteries of union — mystical, gnostic, magical and Hermetic — of that which is below with that which is above. For mysticism, gnosis, magic and Hermetic science are the four branches of the “river” which flows out of our garden of Eden “to water”—the “river” which “divided and became four rivers”.

Meditations on the Tarot. Letter XVI: The Tower of Destruction

Third Judgment of God: Genesis 6:11-22, 7:20-24

In anger, God sends the Flood in order to destroy the corrupted human being.

8.4 Day 4: Fourth blessing of God

Fourth Blessing of God: Genesis 2:19-20

God gives human beings the word: nature was just as human beings named it.

Let us consider the following passage in the Bible, where it says: “And out of the ground the Lord God (Elohim) formed every beast of the field and every bird of the air; and He brought them to Adam to see what he would name them; and whatever Adam called every living creature, that was its name”. This does not mean that the human being invented designations for the beings of the animal kingdom, and even less that he classified them according to genera and species — along the lines of the system of Linnaeus — but rather that he received and fulfilled the divine mandate to determine the vocations or missions relative to the human being of the living creatures hierarchically subordinate to him. For, in the language of the Bible, “name” means “mission” or “activity of being”, and “naming” is the magical act of determining the vocation or mission of a being.

Covenant of the Heart

Fourth Judgment of God: Genesis 11:1-9

God confuses human language (Tower of Babel).

At the root of the building of the tower of Babel is the collective will of “lower selves” to achieve the replacing of the “true Self of the celestial hierarchies and God with a superstructure of universal significance fabricated through this will. The building of the tower of Babel had as its effect the “thunderbolt” of the “descent of the Lord”, who “confused their language” — that of the builders — and “scattered them abroad over the face of all the earth” so that they would no longer understand one another’s language.

Meditations on the Tarot. Letter XVI: The Tower of Destruction

Posted on 2023-03-19 by Cologero

Week 7: Thy Will be done (II)

Task: Work on the seven messages to the seven churches.

And he laid his right hand upon me, saying: Fear not.

I am the First and the Last, and alive, and was dead, and behold I am living for ever and ever, and have the keys of death and of hell. Write therefore the things which thou hast seen, and which are, and which must be done hereafter. The mystery of the seven stars, which thou saw in my right hand, and the seven golden candlesticks.

The seven stars are the angels of the seven churches. And the seven candlesticks are the seven churches.

REV 1:17-20

The seven churches can also be imagined as representing different historical epochs. Each of the churches has a positive and a negative element. These still live in every human being, regardless of the epoch. Our task is to develop the positive elements and overcome the negative elements. These cultural periods are:

- **Ephesus:** The old Indian (Vedic) culture
- **Smyrna:** The old Persian (Zoroastrian) culture
- **Pergamos:** The Chaldean-Egyptian (Hermetic) culture
- **Thyatira:** The Greco-Roman (pagan) culture
- **Sardis:** The Anglo-Germanic (current) culture
- **Philadelphia:** The Slavic-Russian (coming) culture
- **Laodicea:** The American, i.e., Western Hemisphere, (future) culture

There are three churches of the past, two of the present, and two of the future. But do not take the history and geography too literally, for they represent streams that are always active in us.

Further reading: Valentin Tomberg's essays on the letters to the seven churches.

The arcanum of inspiration is of vital practical importance not only for Hermeticism but also for the spiritual history of mankind in general. For just as in the individual human biography there are decisive moments of inspiration, so there are in mankind's biography — which is history — decisive points where far-reaching inspirations enter into the spiritual life of humanity. The great religions are such inspirations.

Meditations on the Tarot. Letter XIV: Temperance

9.1 Day 1: Message to Ephesus

Reading: Matthew 24, Rev 2:1-7

The first message to the church of Ephesus concerns the ancient Indian culture.

Please refer to this letter for the complete hymn.

One finds a profound and breathtaking feeling of these cosmic depths in the cosmogonic hymn of the Rigveda. It awakens in the meditator at least a feeling of the profundity of the fundamental cosmic incentive towards, or feeling for zodiacality.

Meditations on the Tarot. Letter XII The Hanged Man

Unto the angel of the church of Ephesus write: These things saith he, who holdeth the seven stars in his right hand, who walketh in the midst of the seven golden candlesticks.

REV 2:1

The mystery of the seven stars, which thou sawt in my right hand, and the seven golden candlesticks. The seven stars are the angels of the seven churches. And the seven candlesticks are the seven churches.

REV 1:20

I know thy works, and thy labour (toil), and thy patience, and how thou canst not bear them that are evil, and thou hast tried them, who say they are apostles, and are not, and hast found them liars: And thou hast patience, and hast endured for my name, and hast not fainted. But I have somewhat against thee, because thou hast left thy first charity. Be mindful therefore from whence thou art fallen: and do penance, and do the first works. Or else I come to thee, and will move thy candlestick out of its place, except thou do penance.

REV 2:2-5

But this thou hast, that thou hatest the deeds of the Nicolaites, which I also hate.

REV 2:6

Negative Side

The flight from earthly reality in the first (Old Indian) culture, in not wanting to fully incarnate.

Positive Side

Hatred of the Nicolaitans and the false apostles; i.e., either one-sided materialism or false conceptions of Christ.

He, that hath an ear, let him hear what the Spirit saith to the churches: To him, that overcometh, I will give to eat of the tree of life, which is in the paradise of my God.

REV 2:7

9.2 Day 2: Message to Smyrna

Reading: Matthew 24, Rev 2:8-11

The second message to the church of Smyrna concerns the Persian culture.

It is in the Iranian and Judaeo-Christian spiritual currents — i.e., in Zoroastrianism, Judaism and Christianity — that the idea and ideal of resurrection has taken root. The advent of the idea and ideal of resurrection was “as lightning coming from the east and shining as far as the west” (Matthew xxiv, 27). The inspired prophet of the East, namely the great Zarathustra in Iran, and the inspired prophets of the West — Isaiah, Ezekiel and Daniel in Israel — announced it almost simultaneously.

Meditations on the Tarot. Letter XX: The Judgment

And to the angel of the church of Smyrna write: These things saith the First and the Last, who was dead, and is alive: I know thy tribulation and thy poverty, but thou art rich: and thou art blasphemed by them that say they are Jews and are not, but are the synagogue of Satan. Fear none of those things which thou shalt suffer. Behold, the devil will cast some of you into prison that you may be tried: and you shall have tribulation ten days. Be thou faithful until death: and I will give thee the crown of life. (Rev 2:8-10)

Negative Side

The false “we” consciousness: prisoner in the synagogue of Satan or prisoner in one’s own subjective I-consciousness. “Jews” refers to refers to the souls that have decided to serve the Christ impulse. Hence the synagogue of Satan (Ahriman) is a caricature of the Christian community. Or else the devil (Lucifer) will isolate some in their subjective prison.

Positive Side

Faithfulness to the spirit and to the human task on earth. Those united by the Christ impulse freely form a true community.

He, that hath an ear, let him hear what the Spirit saith to the churches: He that shall overcome, shall not be hurt by the second death. (Rev 2:11)

The “good news” of Zarathustra was that the world and Man represented an admixture of two distinct world orders — that of the principle of light and that of the principle of darkness, or the divine-archetypal world order and that of natural evolution — and that the latter would in the end be vanquished by Soshyans “who through will overcomes death”, to be followed by the resurrection of the dead.

Covenant of the Heart

9.3 Day 3: Message to Pergamos

Reading: Matthew 24, Rev 2:12-17

The third message to the church of Pergamos concerns the Egypto-Chaldean culture.

The spiritual impulse behind the third (Egypto-Chaldean) cultural epoch, which has persisted in human souls since that time, is to strive for the experience of immortal individuality and for harmony among immortal individual beings.

Christ and Sophia

And to the angel of the church of Pergamus write: These things, saith he, that hath the sharp two edged sword: I know where thou dwellest, where the seat of Satan is: and thou holdest fast my name, and hast not denied my faith. Even in those days when Antipas was my faithful witness, who was slain among you, where Satan dwelleth.

But I have against thee a few things: because thou hast there them that hold the doctrine of Balaam, who taught Balac to cast a stumbling block before the children of Israel, to eat, and to commit fornication: So hast thou also them that hold the doctrine of the Nicolaites. In like manner do penance: if not, I will come to thee quickly, and will fight against them with the sword of my mouth. (Rev 2:12-16)

This is what St. Justin said about certain Greek philosophers. Although the close inner connection between Alexandrian theosophy and the Christian doctrine is one of the firmly established theses of Western scholarship, for one reason or another, this perfectly correct thesis does not enjoy common acknowledgment in our theological literature. Therefore, I consider it necessary to devote to this question a special appendix at the end of these lectures, where I will touch upon the significance of the native Egyptian

theosophy (the revelations of Thoth or Hermes Trismegistus) in its relation to the doctrines of [the Logos and the Trinity].

VLADIMIR SOLOVYOV, *Lectures on Divine Humanity*

Negative Side

Guidance is sought in the subconscious, out of the blood (Balaam) on the false magical path (Balac). The Nicolaites strain place the ego inside the body, as a substitute for the Real Self.

Positive Side

Because in the depths of the unconscious — which knocks at the door and wants to become conscious — there is present the “sanctuary of the everlasting zones”, where the “Sacred Book of Thoth” remains deposited, from whence symbolic and Hermetic works are born, or reincarnate. The Tarot is such a work.

Meditations on the Tarot. Letter X: The Wheel of Fortune

To retain the forces of the Manas, in order to preserve one’s name, instead of sinking in the blood bonds. The “name” refers to the immortal “I”; the spiritual impulse in this cultural epoch is to strive for the experience of immortal individuality. The I is inscribed on a white stone as a force of community building.

He, that hath an ear, let him hear what the Spirit saith to the churches: To him that overcometh, I will give the hidden manna, and will give him a white counter, and in the counter, a new name written, which no man knoweth, but he that receiveth it. (Rev 2:17)

Then he (Saoshyant) shall restore the world, which will thenceforth never grow old and never die, never decay and never perish, ever live and ever increase, and be master over its wish, when the dead will rise, when life and immortality will come, and the world will be restored at God’s wish.

ZOROASTER

9.4 Day 4: Message to Thyatira

Reading: Matthew 24, Rev 2:18-29

The fourth message to the church of Thyatira concerns the Greco-Roman culture.

The “pagan” initiates and philosophers knew of the unique God — the creator and supreme Good of the world. The difference between the religion of the so-called “pagan” initiates and philosophers and that of Moses is simply the fact that the latter made monotheism a popular religion, whilst the former reserved it for the elite, for the spiritual aristocracy ... With respect to the cult of the “gods” and the iconolatry that this cult entailed, the “pagan” initiates and philosophers saw in it the practice of theurgy, i.e., that of intercourse with entities of the celestial hierarchies either by raising themselves to them, or by rendering possible their descent and presence on earth ... It goes without saying that the “paganism” of the initiates and sages, when not degenerated, had nothing to do with the cult of collectively engendered demons. ... Its “gods” were, truth to tell, human personages — heroes and heroines, divinised or poerised, who were prototypes of the development of the human personality, i.e., planetary and zodiacal types. Thus Jupiter, Juno, Mars, Venus, Mercury, Diana, Apollo, etc., were not at all demons, but leading prototypes of the development of the human personality who, in their turn, corresponded to cosmic — planetary and zodiacal — principles. ... “naturalistic paganism” was “cosmolatry”, i.e. it did not go beyond the limits of Nature like natural science today. It was, therefore, “neutral” from the point of view both of the true spiritual world and of the demons.

Meditations on the Tarot. Letter XV: The Devil

And to the angel of the church of Thyatira write: These things saith

the Son of God, who hath his eyes like to a flame of fire, and his feet like to fine brass. I know thy works, and thy faith, and thy charity, and thy ministry, and thy patience, and thy last works which are more than the former.

But I have against thee a few things: because thou sufferest the woman Jezebel, who calleth herself a prophetess, to teach, and to seduce my servants, to commit fornication, and to eat of things sacrificed to idols. And I gave her a time that she might do penance, and she will not repent of her fornication. Behold, I will cast her into a bed: and they that commit adultery with her shall be in very great tribulation, except they do penance from their deeds. And I will kill her children with death, and all the churches shall know that I am he that searcheth the reins and hearts, and I will give to every one of you according to your works.

But to you I say, and to the rest who are at Thyatira: Whosoever have not this doctrine, and who have not known the depths of Satan, as they say, I will not put upon you any other burden. Yet that, which you have, hold fast till I come. And he that shall overcome, and keep my works unto the end, I will give him power over the nations. And he shall rule them with a rod of iron, and as the vessel of a potter they shall be broken, as I also have received of my Father: and I will give him the morning star. (Rev 2:18-28)

Negative Side

The fourth form of paganism is that of the worship of collectively engendered demons. This form of paganism, which is due to the degeneration of the other three forms is the only form of paganism where demons were engendered, worshipped and obeyed, and which led to the whole of paganism being renamed unjustly and calumniously as the “demoniacal religion”.

Meditations on the Tarot. Letter XV: The Devil

There is a confused life in Thyatira. Fornication is a serious transgression, is not compromise, it is a false surrender to everything. It is the failure to keep to what one has said. The not wanting to say yes or no. Decadent false prophets, false devotion to everything without wishing to make a choice. They get involved with Sybilline oracles through Jezebel.

Positive Side

The force of the I, which has backbone in the spirit. The upright posture in the new spirit, the spirit of Christ. They show the way to overcome the curses of toil (through service), suffering (through patience), and death (through faith). And love (charity) is the fourth quality.

He that hath an ear, let him hear what the Spirit saith to the churches. (Rev 2:29)

9.5 Day 5: Message to Sardis

Reading: Luke 21, Rev 3:1-6

The fifth message to the church of Sardis concerns the Anglo-Germanic culture.

The historian of the future, if he has discerned the difference between the way, the truth, and the life on the one hand and the stream of natural evolution on the other, will not compose a history of civilization — that is, the story of technological progress and socio-political struggles — but will trace the path of mankind through the stages of purification and illumination to its ultimate attainment of perfection. His narrative will detail mankind's temptations and their vanquishment, the standards set by particular individuals and groups, and the progressive lighting-up of new insights and the awakening of spiritual faculties among human beings.

Covenant of the Heart

And to the angel of the church of Sardis, write: These things saith he, that hath the seven spirits of God, and the seven stars:

I know thy works, that thou hast the name of being alive: and thou art dead. Be watchful and strengthen the things that remain, which are ready to die. For I find not thy works full before my God. Have in mind therefore in what manner thou hast received and heard: and observe, and do penance. If then thou shalt not watch, I will come to thee as a thief, and thou shalt not know at what hour I will come to thee.

But thou hast a few names in Sardis, which have not defiled their garments: and they shall walk with me in white, because they are worthy. He that shall overcome, shall thus be clothed in white garments, and I will not blot out his name out of the book of life, and I will confess his name before my Father, and before his angels. (Rev 3:1-5)

Negative Side

The church at Sardis was vice-ridden and restless. Remaining asleep to all that is spiritual, and affirmation of what is fated to die. Without God everything is fated to die. Remaining asleep to this mission, just as our entire culture is without God. Science, art, and religion, without God, are fated to die.

Positive Side

Through the forces of death, to experience an incentive to seek for life and for God. If one has found God and one breathes in God, then one has life. Be wakeful and conscious of your task.

He that hath an ear, let him hear what the Spirit saith to the churches. (Rev 3:6)

9.6 Day 6: Message to Philadelphia

Reading: Luke 21, Rev 3:7-13

The sixth message to the church of Philadelphia concerns the Slavic epoch.

In this period, culture will be that of the Christ impulse flowing through all humankind — no longer just a doctrine, but most of all a social force. This culture will have settlements in “all nations,” a bond of friendly unity among humankind that binds nations and lands together all round the Earth. It will be the fruit of adjusting the relationship between right and left in the spirit of the experience that results from the trial by scourging.

Christ and Sophia

And to the angel of the church of Philadelphia, write: These things saith the Holy One and the true one, he that hath the key of David; he that openeth, and no man shutteth; shutteth, and no man openeth:

I know thy works. Behold, I have given before thee a door opened, which no man can shut: because thou hast a little strength, and hast kept my word, and hast not denied my name. Behold, I will bring of the synagogue of Satan, who say they are Jews, and are not, but do lie. Behold, I will make them to come and adore before thy feet. And they shall know that I have loved thee.

Because thou hast kept the word of my patience, I will also keep thee from the hour of the temptation, which shall come upon the whole world to try them that dwell upon the earth. Behold, I come quickly: hold fast that which thou hast, that no man take thy crown. He that shall overcome, I will make him a pillar in the temple of my God; and he shall go out no more; and I will write upon him the name of my God, and the name of the city of my God, the new Jerusalem, which cometh down out of heaven from my God, and my new name. (Rev 3:7-12)

Negative Side

This message points to a weakness of the will and fear of the world. One loses one's hold on things and becomes passive. One's own will comes to a halt and falls asleep.

Positive Side

To stand like a pillar in the temple — a stage of consciousness in the human being where he stands firmly in God and in the name of Christ. The crown must be worn actively and with dignity, although the I is already resting in the Christ. The crown is attained through effort.

He that hath an ear, let him hear what the Spirit saith to the churches. (Rev 3:13)

9.7 Day 7: Message to Laodicea

Reading: Luke 21, Rev 3:14-22

The seventh message to the church of Philadelphia concerns the American epoch.

The seventh cultural epoch (called Laodicea in the Apocalypse), on the other hand, will have as its main destiny the fight between denial of the future, or hopelessness, and the Christian affirmation of the future's resurrection, or hope.

Christ and Sophia

And to the angel of the church of Laodicea, write: These things saith the Amen, the faithful and true witness, who is the beginning of the creation of God:

I know thy works, that thou art neither cold, nor hot. I would thou wert cold, or hot. But because thou art lukewarm, and neither cold, nor hot, I will begin to vomit thee out of my mouth. Because thou sayest: I am rich, and made wealthy, and have need of nothing: and knowest not, that thou art wretched, and miserable, and poor, and blind, and naked. I counsel thee to buy of me gold fire tried, that thou mayest be made rich; and mayest be clothed in white garments, and that the shame of thy nakedness may not appear; and anoint thy eyes with eye salve, that thou mayest see.

Such as I love, I rebuke and chastise. Be zealous therefore, and do penance. Behold, I stand at the gate, and knock. If any man shall hear my voice, and open to me the door, I will come in to him, and will sup with him, and he with me. To him that shall overcome, I will give to sit with me in my throne: as I also have overcome, and am set down with my Father in his throne. (Rev 3:14-22)

Negative Side

There is restlessness and arrogance in Laodicea. Feeling rich in the treasures gained in the past and resting upon these, with no further striving. The opposite of begging for spirit. Neither cold nor warm, but lukewarm.

Positive Side

To strive continually onwards and in humility to give away even the highest one has attained, so that it can become an organ for what is still higher. The greatest wealth, without knowledge of it. Renunciation of what one has attained and to do so eagerly.

He that hath an ear, let him hear what the Spirit saith to the churches. (Rev 3:22)

Posted on 2023-03-26 by Cologero

Week 8: Give us this day our daily bread

TASK FOR THE WEEK: Meditate on the good communion, be wary of the bad communion.

READING FOR THE WEEK: John 13-17

10.1 Day 1: Spiritual-physical nourishment

The Good Communion

And God blessed them, saying: Increase and multiply, and fill the earth, and subdue it, and rule over the fishes of the sea, and the fowls of the air, and all living creatures that move upon the earth. And God said: Behold I have given you every herb bearing seed upon the earth, and all trees that have in themselves seed of their own kind, to be your meat: And to all beasts of the earth, and to every fowl of the air, and to all that move upon the earth, and wherein there is life, that they may have to feed upon. And it was so done.

Genesis 1:28-30

Through spiritual-physical nourishment (the seed forces), Adam connected himself with all the good forces. He mastered the active forces.

Seed forces arise from the root chakra on the Tree of Life.

Chastity is the state of the human being where the centre named in occidental esotericism as the “twelve-petalled lotus” is awakened and becomes the sun of the microcosmic “planetary system”. The three lotus-centres situated below it (the ten-petalled, the six-petalled, and the four-petalled) begin then to function in conformity with the life of the heart (the twelve-petalled lotus), i.e., “according to solar law”.

Meditations on the Tarot. Letter V: The Pope

The four-petalled lotus is that of creative force.

The Evil Communion

The evil seed-force was forbidden. That was the origin of the good and evil communions. It destroyed the petals of the root chakra, or life forces. This is the forbidden fruit.

Concerning the centre from which the current necessary for “Simonian” levitation is made to emanate: it is that of the “four-petalled lotus” (*muladhara chakra*), where the “serpent power” (*kundalini*) — latent electrical force — is found. Now, this “serpent power” can be awoken and directed either above (yoga) or below and outside (arbitrary magic).

Meditations on the Tarot. Letter XII: The Hanged Man

10.2 Day 2: Abraham’s Initiation

The Good Communion

And Sarai said to Abram: Thou dost unjustly with me: I gave my handmaid into thy bosom, and she perceiving herself to be with child, despiseth me. The Lord judge between me and thee.

Genesis 16:5

Abram was confronted with the choice between good and evil communion.

Abram = sublime father; Abraham = father of a multitude.

But Melchizedek the king of Salem, bringing forth bread and wine, for he was the priest of the most high God, Blessed him, and said: Blessed be Abram by the most high God, who created heaven and earth.

Genesis 14:18-19

Melchizedek = king of righteousness; Salem = king of peace. Abraham was initiated with bread and wine.

For this Melchizedek was king of Salem, priest of the most high God, who met Abraham returning from the slaughter of the kings, and blessed him: To whom also Abraham divided the tithes of all: who first indeed by interpretation, is king of justice: and then also king of Salem, that is, king of peace: Without father, without mother, without genealogy, having neither beginning of days nor end of life, but likened unto the Son of God, continueth a priest forever. Now consider how great this man is, to whom also Abraham the patriarch gave tithes out of the principal things.

Hebrews 7:1-4

Primordial water penetrated by divine breath is the essence of blood; breath reflected by the water is light; the rhythmic alternation from absorption of the breath by water to its reflection by it is respiration. Light is the day, blood is the night, and respiration is plenitude (Salem). Melchizedek, king of Salem, priest of the

Most High God is therefore appointed to plenitude, to respiration, whilst the anointed king, guardian of the throne of David, or the Emperor, is appointed to the day.

Meditations on the Tarot. Letter V: The Pope

The Evil Communion

And the king of Sodom said to Abram: Give me the persons, and the rest take to thyself. And he answered him: I lift up my hand to the Lord God the most high, the possessor of heaven and earth, that from the very woof thread unto the shoe latchet, I will not take of any things that are thine, lest thou say I have enriched Abram: Except such things as the young men have eaten, and the shares of the men that came with me, Aner, Escol, and Mambre: these shall take their shares.

Genesis 14:21-24

Abraham refused the evil offer to become king of Sodom and Gomorrah.

The king of Sodom offers Abram bread (the provision for the two cities) and stone (the conquered cities of the enemy kings).

If ten righteous men had been found in Sodom and Gomorrah, God would have spared these cities.

Meditations on the Tarot. Letter X: The Wheel of Fortune

10.3 Day 3: Moses feeds his people

THE GOOD COMMUNION: It is a good communion when Moses feeds his people with Manna.

And the Lord said to Moses: Behold I will rain bread from heaven for you: let the people go forth, and gather what is sufficient for every day: that I may prove them whether they will walk in my law, or not. But the sixth day let them provide for to bring in: and let it be double to that they were wont to gather every day.

Exodus 16:4-5

So it came to pass in the evening, that quails coming up, covered the camp: and in the morning, a dew lay round about the camp. And when it had covered the face of the earth, it appeared in the wilderness small, and as it were beaten with a pestle, like unto the hoar frost on the ground. And when the children of Israel saw it, they said one to another: Manhu! which signifieth: What is this! for they knew not what it was. And Moses said to them: This is the bread, which the Lord hath given you to eat. This is the word, that the Lord hath commanded: Let everyone gather of it as much as is enough to eat: a gomor for every man, according to the number of your souls that dwell in a tent, so shall you take of it. And the

children of Israel did so: and they gathered, one more, another less. And they measured by the measure of a gomor: neither had he more that had gathered more: nor did he find less that had provided less: but everyone had gathered, according to what they were able to eat.

Exodus 16:13-18

They said therefore to him: What sign therefore dost thou shew, that we may see, and may believe thee? What dost thou work? Our fathers did eat manna in the desert, as it is written: He gave them bread from heaven to eat. Then Jesus said to them: Amen, amen I say to you; Moses gave you not bread from heaven, but my Father giveth you the true bread from heaven. For the bread of God is that which cometh down from heaven, and giveth life to the world. They said therefore unto him: Lord, give us always this bread. And Jesus said to them: **I am the bread of life:** he that cometh to me shall not hunger: and he that believeth in me shall never thirst.

John 6:30-35

St. John of the Cross understands the way of purification through the inner desert as a path for mature souls who are strong enough to bear the tediousness, stillness, and loneliness of the “night of

the spirit.” Nevertheless, these souls also have need of being strengthened, encouraged, and cheered up. It is one of the experiences that every human being who treads the “desert path” knows, that at night, in the condition of sleep, something happens that gives him again and again new strength to endure and not to despair. The night, which seems to be just as desert-like, unmoving, and dark as the “night of the spirit” experienced during the waking consciousness of day, in time transforms itself into a giver of strength of soul and courage of spirit for the human being. It is as if something received as a kind of aftereffect from the heavenly choirs of the spiritual hierarchies was actively giving new life and strength to the soul (and often to the body, too) of the awakened wanderer. The result is renewed courage for life and the temporary disappearing of any lack of hope. This strengthening is not due to a dream or any kind of instruction during dreaming, but purely and simply to the condition resulting during the night. Despondency, or even despair, simply disappears by itself, and one is reinvigorated and strengthened to continue the “path through the desert.” It is not arbitrary to compare this aftereffect of the night with the miraculous nourishment of **manna**, to see here an analogy with this feeding of the chosen people in the desert during their wandering through the wilderness.

Covenant of the Heart

THE EVIL COMMUNION: Evil communion is the worship of the golden calf and yearning for the fleshpots of Egypt.

The golden calf is imitated in the worship of those who attend to external life without awakening to life, i.e., without making an effort to acquire exact knowledge of the laws of life.

Now, there is the Word, and there are egregores before whom humanity bows down; there is revelation of divine truth, and the manifestation of the will of human beings; there is the cult of God, and that of idols

made by man. Is it not a diagnosis and prognosis of the whole history of the human race that at the same time that Moses received the revelation of the Word at the summit of the mountain, the people at the foot of the mountain made and worshipped a golden calf?

The Word and idols, revealed truth and “ideological superstructures” of the human will, operate simultaneously in the history of the human race. Has there been a single century when the servants of the Word have not had to confront the worshippers of idols, egregores?

Meditations on the Tarot. Letter XV: The Devil

Those at the foot of the mountain collected contributions of gold jewelry and made from them the so-called golden calf, the idol of a golden bull. With respect to this archetypal phenomenon of “falling away,” it is not a question merely of the victory of inclination—preferring the sense perceptible and material to what is supersensible and purely moral—but of something deeper and more significant. It is actually a matter of an insurrection of the collective will of the people asserting itself against the aristocratic, hierarchical order that Moses represented.

The turning away from the God who was revealed and proclaimed, in favor of the self-chosen and created god is, as it is depicted in the Bible, the original phenomenon of all stages and forms of falling away from the truths of revelation in favor of the collective will of the people, which usually comes to expression as the demand for being in tune with the “spirit of the times.”

The “golden calf” was made and took the place of the dogma of the God of Being. The “golden calf” came about not through doubt in the revelation proclaimed through Moses, but to make it plausible.

When Yahweh wanted to destroy the people of Israel because of their turning away from Him and on account of their worship

of the golden calf at the foot of Mt. Sinai, Moses asked that he, instead, be blotted out from the book of life rather than that the people of Israel be destroyed. Thus he attained pardon for the people of Israel. In his sacrificial willingness a deeper understanding of the divine expressed itself.

Covenant of the Heart

And the people seeing that Moses delayed to come down from the mount, gathering together against Aaron, said: Arise, make us gods, that may go before us: for as to this Moses, the man that brought us out of the land of Egypt, we know not what has befallen him. And Aaron said to them: Take the golden earrings from the ears of your wives, and your sons and daughters, and bring them to me. And the people did what he had commanded, bringing the earrings to Aaron. And when he had received them, he fashioned them by founders' work, and made of them a molten calf. And they said: These are thy gods, O Israel, that have brought thee out of the land of Egypt. And when Aaron saw this, he built an altar before it, and made proclamation by a crier's voice, saying: Tomorrow is the solemnity of

the Lord. And rising in the morning, they offered holocausts, and peace victims, and the people sat down to eat, and drink, and they rose up to play. And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying: Go, get thee down: thy people, which thou hast brought out of the land of Egypt, hath sinned. They have quickly strayed from the way which thou didst shew them: and they have made to themselves a molten calf, and have adored it, and sacrificing victims to it, have said: These are thy gods, O Israel, that have brought thee out of the land of Egypt. And again the Lord said to Moses: See that this people is stiff-necked: Let me alone, that my wrath may be kindled against them, and that I may destroy them, and I will make of thee a great nation.

Exodus 32:1-10

10.3.1 The fleshpots of Egypt

The exodus out of Egypt and the wandering in the desert preceded the revelation on Mt. Sinai. For Egypt was the epitome of all kinds of worship of the elements of existence in space (sun, moon, and stars) and in time (fertility, the power of procreation, life and death, natural evolution), i.e., those very things that work as necessities of nature and represent what is coercive about worldly existence.

Egypt was the “house of bondage” because of the worship of the compelling necessities of existence, the “gods” of material being. The exodus of the Israelites out of Egypt was for this reason an unprecedented revolutionary event: a multitude of human beings wanted to go forth into the desert in order to worship there the God who is not to be found in material existence.

Covenant of the Heart

And they chode with Moses, and said: Give us water, that we may drink. And Moses answered them: Why chide you with me? Wherefore do you tempt the Lord? So the people were thirsty there for want of water, and murmured against Moses, saying: Why didst thou make us go forth out of Egypt, to kill us and our children, and our beasts with thirst?

Exodus 17:2-3

10.4 Day 4: The Feeding of the 5000

The feeding of the 5000 with five barley loaves and two fishes.

After these things Jesus went over the sea of Galilee, which is that of Tiberias. And a great multitude followed him, because they saw the miracles which he did on them that were diseased. Jesus therefore went up into a mountain, and there he sat with his disciples. Now the pasch, the festival day of the Jews, was near at hand. When Jesus therefore had lifted up his eyes, and seen that a very great multitude cometh to him, he said to Philip: Whence shall we buy bread, that these may eat? And this he said to try him; for he himself knew what he would do. Philip answered him: Two hundred pennyworth of bread is not sufficient for them, that every one may take a little. One of his disciples, Andrew, the brother of Simon Peter, saith to him:

There is a boy here that hath five barley loaves, and two fishes; but what are these among so many?

Then Jesus said: Make the men sit

down.

Now there was much grass in the place. The men therefore sat down, in number about five thousand. And Jesus took the loaves: and when he had given thanks, he distributed to them that were set down. In like manner also of the fishes, as much as they would. And when they were filled, he said to his disciples: Gather up the fragments that remain, lest they be lost. They gathered up therefore, and filled twelve baskets with the fragments of the five barley loaves, which remained over and above to them that had eaten. Now those men, when they had seen what a miracle Jesus had done, said: This is of a truth the prophet, that is to come into the world. Jesus therefore, when he knew that they would come to take him by force, and make him king, fled again into the mountain himself alone.

John 6:1-15

THE GOOD COMMUNION: Drives that spring from love bring about healings. Love is present only where the human being is able to act out of intuition consciously acquired.

The seven miracles in John's Gospel did not have the serpent as their agent, nor was the brain the instrument of their accomplishment, nor was cerebral intellectuality the source of their initiative. The agent here is the dove, i.e., the Spirit which is above the brain, above the head, and which *descends* upon the head and remains

there — the Spirit which *transcends* cerebral intellectuality. This Spirit is the source of initiative and, simultaneously, is the agent and instrument of divine or sacred magic.

Meditations on the Tarot. Letter X: The Wheel of Fortune

As the Sun — raying out light, warmth, and life — “nourishes” all beings and unites them in a “community of nourishment,” so Jesus Christ functioned at the feeding of the five thousand as the “nourishment giving center” for the five thousand. He carried out during the short time of the “feeding” what the sun effects in the course of the year, when it brings about a “multiplication of bread” through the sprouting, growth, and ripening of corn.

The disciples received and passed on the blest (eucharistic) bread, just as the moon receives and passes on the light of the sun in a dimmed, toned-down form.

This mediating effect of the moon, which transforms the boundless, streaming strength of the sun such that it becomes more individually acceptable, can also be understood in relation to the experience of the sacrament of holy communion received at the altar.

THE EVIL COMMUNION: Feedings that take place without Christ fulfil the purposes of Ahriman. They are feeding out of the heart of Satan and strengthening the I via currents of the fallen chakras. The feeding always enters into a man when a destruction of the seed is undertaken out of passion. Ahriman enters their hearts, haunting the life-sphere and destroying the life-forces in the life-centre of the heart.

10.5 Day 5: The Last Supper

THE GOOD COMMUNION: The Last Supper.

Scriptural readings: Matthew 26:20-30, Mark 14:17-26, Luke 22:7-23

Teresa Neumann lived in our time at Konnersreuth (Bavaria) solely from Holy Communion for decades; St. Catherine of Sienna lived nine years from Holy Communion alone; St. Lidvina of Schiedam (near Rotterdam, Holland) likewise lived for many years exclusively from Holy Communion—to cite only the cases that are well-verified.

This is the significance of the words: “Man shall not live by bread alone but by every word that proceeds from the mouth of God.” Here is its principal implication: as the law of evolution, the law of the serpent, comprises the struggle for existence and as “bread” or food is the principal factor in the struggle for existence, the fact of the entry of grace into human history since Jesus Christ signifies at the same time the possibility of gradually abolishing the struggle for existence.

Meditations on the Tarot. Letter VI: The Lover

Christ’s last words at the institution of the holy sacrament at the Last Supper: “Do this in memory of me” point toward the sacraments, too, as being a reenlivening in the present of what happened in the past. In the holy sacrament at the altar, memory becomes an act of the divine magic of transubstantiation, an act relating to the real (not just remembered) presence of the body and blood of the Redeemer. What once took place, takes place now in the present. In the sacrament, memory does not become a journey into the past, but instead brings the past into present, an evocation that summons something out of the realm of forgetting, sleep, and death.

The words: “Do this in memory of me” actually mean: “Do this, so that I may be present.”

Covenant of the Heart

THE EVIL COMMUNION: The temptation of Jesus in the wilderness.

Scriptural Reading: Matthew 4:1-11

The temptation to Materialism:

And when he had fasted forty days and forty nights, afterwards he was hungry. And the tempter coming said to him: If thou be the Son of God, command that these stones be made bread. Who answered and said: It is written, Not in bread alone doth man live, but in every word that proceedeth from the mouth of God.

Matthew 4:2-4

10.5.1 Bible Passages

But when it was evening, he sat down with his twelve disciples. And whilst they were eating, he said: Amen I say to you, that one of you is about to betray me. And they being very much troubled, began everyone to say: Is it I, Lord? But he answering, said: He that dippeth his hand with me in the dish, he shall betray me. The Son of man indeed goeth, as it is written of him: but woe to that man by whom the Son of man shall be betrayed: it were better for him, if that man had not been born. And Judas that betrayed him, answering, said: Is it I, Rabbi? He saith to him: Thou hast said it. And whilst they were at supper, Jesus took bread, and blessed, and broke: and gave to his disciples, and said: Take ye, and eat. This

is my body. And taking the chalice, he gave thanks, and gave to them, saying: Drink ye all of this. For this is my blood of the new testament, which shall be shed for many unto remission of sins. And I say to you, I will not drink from henceforth of this fruit of the vine, until that day when I shall drink it with you new in the kingdom of my Father. And a hymn being said, they went out unto mount Olivet.

Matthew 26:20-30

And when evening was come, he cometh with the twelve. And when they were at table and eating, Jesus saith: Amen I say to you, one of you that eateth with me shall betray me. But they began to be sorrowful, and

to say to him one by one: Is it I? Who saith to them: One of the twelve, who dippeth with me his hand in the dish. And the Son of man indeed goeth, as it is written of him: but woe to that man by whom the Son of man shall be betrayed. It were better for him, if that man had not been born. And whilst they were eating, Jesus took bread; and blessing, broke, and gave to them, and said: Take ye. This is my body. And having taken the chalice, giving thanks, he gave it to them. And they all drank of it. And he said to them: This is my blood of the new testament, which shall be shed for many. Amen I say to you, that I will drink no more of the fruit of the vine, until that day when I shall drink it new in the kingdom of God. And when they had said an hymn, they went forth to the mount of Olives.

Mark 14:17-26

And the day of the unleavened bread came, on which it was necessary that the pasch should be killed. And he sent Peter and John, saying: Go, and prepare for us the pasch, that we may eat. But they said: Where wilt thou that we prepare? And he said to them: Behold, as you go into the city, there shall meet you a man carrying a pitcher of water: follow him into

the house where he entereth in. And you shall say to the goodman of the house: The master saith to thee, Where is the guest chamber, where I may eat the pasch with my disciples? And he will shew you a large dining room, furnished; and there prepare. And they going, found as he had said to them, and made ready the pasch. And when the hour was come, he sat down, and the twelve apostles with him. And he said to them: With desire I have desired to eat this pasch with you, before I suffer. For I say to you, that from this time I will not eat it, till it be fulfilled in the kingdom of God. And having taken the chalice, he gave thanks, and said: Take, and divide it among you: For I say to you, that I will not drink of the fruit of the vine, till the kingdom of God come. And taking bread, he gave thanks, and brake; and gave to them, saying: This is my body, which is given for you. Do this for a commemoration of me. In like manner the chalice also, after he had supped, saying: This is the chalice, the new testament in my blood, which shall be shed for you. But yet behold, the hand of him that betrayeth me is with me on the table. And the Son of man indeed goeth, according to that which is determined: but yet, woe to that man by whom he

shall be betrayed. And they began to inquire among themselves, which of them it was that should do this thing.

Luke 22:7-23

Then Jesus was led by the spirit into the desert, to be tempted by the devil. And when he had fasted forty days and forty nights, afterwards he was hungry. And the tempter coming said to him: If thou be the Son of God, command that these stones be made bread. Who answered and said: It is written, Not in bread alone doth man live, but in every word that proceedeth from the mouth of God. Then the devil took him up into the holy city, and set him upon the pinnacle of the temple, And said to him: If thou be

the Son of God, cast thyself down, for it is written: That he hath given his angels charge over thee, and in their hands shall they bear thee up, lest perhaps thou dash thy foot against a stone. Jesus said to him: It is written again: Thou shalt not tempt the Lord thy God. Again the devil took him up into a very high mountain, and shewed him all the kingdoms of the world, and the glory of them, And said to him: All these will I give thee, if falling down thou wilt adore me. Then Jesus saith to him: Begone, Satan: for it is written, The Lord thy God shalt thou adore, and him only shalt thou serve. Then the devil left him; and behold angels came and ministered to him.

Matthew 4:1-11

10.6 Day 6: Instituting the Eucharist

Meditation on Luke 22:7-38.

The Good Communion: The Eucharist

The Eucharist is the whole of Christianity; and through it Christianity has become living magic. Since Jesus there are still sorcerers, (but) there are no more mages.

JOSEPHIN PELADAN

On the day of the unleavened bread, Jesus and the disciples had a meal in a large, furnished dining room.

The Jesus established the Eucharist with the bread and wine.

The Evil Communion: betrayal, strife, and denial

Although participated in the first Eucharist, there was an evil side.

- **BETRAYAL:** Jesus predicted Judas' betrayal
- **STRIFE:** The disciples bickered among themselves for positions of power and authority
- **DENIAL:** Jesus predicted Peter's denial

10.6.1 Bible passages: The Last Supper

And the day of the unleavened bread came, on which it was necessary that the pasch should be killed. And he sent Peter and John, saying: Go, and prepare for us the pasch, that we may eat. But they said: Where wilt thou that we prepare? And he said to them: Behold, as you go into the city, there shall meet you a man carrying a pitcher of water: follow him into the house where he entereth in. And you shall say to the goodman of the house: The master saith to thee, Where is the guest chamber, where I may eat the pasch with my disciples? And he will shew you a large dining room, furnished; and there prepare. And they going, found as he had said to them, and made ready the pasch. And when the hour was come, he sat down, and

the twelve apostles with him. And he said to them: With desire I have desired to eat this pasch with you, before I suffer. For I say to you, that from this time I will not eat it, till it be fulfilled in the kingdom of God.

And having taken the chalice, he gave thanks, and said: Take, and divide it among you: For I say to you, that I will not drink of the fruit of the vine, till the kingdom of God come. And taking bread, he gave thanks, and brake; and gave to them, saying: This is my body, which is given for you. Do this for a commemoration of me. In like manner the chalice also, after he had supped, saying: This is the chalice, the new testament in my blood, which shall be shed for you.

But yet behold, the hand of him

that betrayeth me is with me on the table. And the Son of man indeed goeth, according to that which is determined: but yet, woe to that man by whom he shall be betrayed. And they began to inquire among themselves, which of them it was that should do this thing. And there was also a strife amongst them, which of them should seem to be the greater. And he said to them: The kings of the Gentiles lord it over them; and they that have power over them, are called beneficent. But you not so: but he that is the greater among you, let him become as the younger; and he that is the leader, as he that serveth. For which is greater, he that sitteth at table, or he that serveth? Is it not he that sitteth at table? But I am in the midst of you, as he that serveth: And you are they who have continued with me in my temptations:

And I dispose to you, as my Father hath disposed to me, a kingdom; that you may eat and drink at my table, in my kingdom: and may sit upon thrones, judging the twelve tribes of Is-

rael. And the Lord said: Simon, Simon, behold Satan hath desired to have you, that he may sift you as wheat: But I have prayed for thee, that thy faith fail not: and thou, being once converted, confirm thy brethren. Who said to him: Lord, I am ready to go with thee, both into prison, and to death. And he said: I say to thee, Peter, the cock shall not crow this day, till thou thrice deniest that thou knowest me. And he said to them: When I sent you without purse, and scrip, and shoes, did you want anything? But they said: Nothing. Then said he unto them: But now he that hath a purse, let him take it, and likewise a scrip; and he that hath not, let him sell his coat, and buy a sword. For I say to you, that this that is written must yet be fulfilled in me: And with the wicked was he reckoned. For the things concerning me have an end. But they said: Lord, behold here are two swords. And he said to them, It is enough.

Luke 22:7-38

10.6.2 The Temptations in the Desert

And Jesus being full of the Holy Ghost, returned from the Jordan, and was led by the Spirit into the desert,

for the space of forty days; and was tempted by the devil. And he ate nothing in those days; and when they were

ended, he was hungry.

And the devil said to him: If thou be the Son of God, say to this stone that it be made bread. And Jesus answered him: It is written, that Man liveth not by bread alone, but by every word of God. And the devil led him into a high mountain, and shewed him all the kingdoms of the world in a moment of time; and he said to him: To thee will I give all this power, and the glory of them; for to me they are delivered, and to whom I will, I give them. If thou therefore wilt adore before me, all shall be thine. And Jesus answering said to him: It is written: Thou shalt adore the Lord thy God, and him only

shalt thou serve.

And he brought him to Jerusalem, and set him on a pinnacle of the temple, and he said to him: If thou be the Son of God, cast thyself from hence. For it is written, that He hath given his angels charge over thee, that they keep thee. And that in their hands they shall bear thee up, lest perhaps thou dash thy foot against a stone. And Jesus answering, said to him: It is said: Thou shalt not tempt the Lord thy God.

And all the temptation being ended, the devil departed from him for a time.

Luke 4:1-13

10.7 Day 7: The Road to Emmaus

The state of the risen Jesus Christ is the goal and the hope of the path of destiny of humanity. It is the most perfect ideal of which one could ever think or dream. For it unites the most far reaching hopes of the noblest ideals of this world with the highest and deepest ideals of the world beyond.

The Good Communion

And it happened that, while he was with them at table, he took bread, said the blessing, broke it, and gave it to them. With that their eyes were opened and they recognized him, but he vanished from their sight.

Luke 24:30-31

It was always through a sign that the Risen One let himself be

known. For the form and appearance of the Risen One differed from Jesus of Nazareth through the fact of being timeless and ageless. His countenance was simply the expression of his being—of his spirit and his soul—and could only be recognised by those who through the sheath of his bodily self had known something of his true being, his soul, and his spirit. And the signs by which the Risen One let himself be known were such as to give a pointer and an indication toward their personal earlier experience and knowledge of the soul-spiritual being of Jesus. They were reminded of their earlier experience and knowledge of the being of Jesus Christ.

Covenant of the Heart

The Risen One did not appear in the likeness of Jesus, as those nearest to him had known him immediately before the Crucifixion and earlier; that is, not as the resuscitated or reawakened Jesus who had been crucified, nor the Jesus who had been baptised in the Jordan—but Jesus in a new form. For this reason, those people who had known him recognised him only by some intimate sign.

Thus, Mary Magdalena, who at first took him for a gardener, recognised him only by the manner in which he pronounced her name “Mary.” Thomas recognised him when the Risen One showed him the marks of his wounds. *The two disciples from Emmaus knew him in the breaking of bread.*

The heart perceives diverse presences as impressions and nuances of spiritual warmth. It is thus that the hearts of the two disciples going to Emmaus recognised the One who went on the way with them before their eyes and their understanding did, and who said to one another after their eyes opened and they recognised him: “Did not our hearts burn within us while he talked to us on the road, while he opened to us the scriptures?” The heart burning

in diverse ways — this is the kind of “vision” and spiritual knowledge which is proper to the heart.

Meditations on the Tarot. Letter XII: The Hanged Man

The Evil Communion

Tradition lives not thanks to organisations, but rather in spite of them. One should content oneself purely and simply with friendship in order to preserve the life of a tradition; it is not necessary to entrust it to the care of the embalmers and mummifiers par excellence that organisations are, except for the one founded by Jesus Christ.

Meditations on the Tarot. Letter XX: Judgment

The mummification of the Pharaohs in ancient Egypt.

There will come a time when it will be seen that in vain have the Egyptians honoured the deity with heartfelt piety and assiduous service; and all our holy worship will be found bootless and ineffectual. For the gods will return from earth to heaven; Egypt will be forsaken, and the land which was once the home of religion will be left desolate, bereft of the presence of its deities. This land and region will be filled with foreigners. . . In that day will our most holy land, this land of shrines and temples, be filled with funerals and corpses.

HERMES TRISMEGISTUS, *Asclepius*

Bible Passage

And behold, two of them went, the same day, to a town which was sixty furlongs from Jerusalem, named Emmaus. And they talked together of all these things which had happened. And it came to pass, that while they talked and reasoned with themselves, Jesus himself also drawing near, went with them. But their eyes were held, that they should not know him. And he said to them: What are these discourses that you hold one with another as you walk, and are sad?

And the one of them, whose name was Cleophas, answering, said to him: Art thou only a stranger to Jerusalem, and hast not known the things that have been done there in these days? To whom he said: What things? And they said: Concerning Jesus of Nazareth, who was a prophet, mighty in work and word before God and all the people; and how our chief priests and princes delivered him to be condemned to death, and crucified him. But we hoped, that it was he that should have redeemed Israel: and now besides all this, today is the third day since these things were done.

Yea and certain women also of our company affrighted us, who before it was light, were at the sepulchre. And not finding his body, came, saying, that

they had also seen a vision of angels, who say that he is alive. And some of our people went to the sepulchre, and found it so as the women had said, but him they found not.

Then he said to them: O foolish, and slow of heart to believe in all things which the prophets have spoken. Ought not Christ to have suffered these things, and so to enter into his glory? And beginning at Moses and all the prophets, he expounded to them in all the scriptures, the things that were concerning him. And they drew nigh to the town, whither they were going: and he made as though he would go farther.

But they constrained him; saying: Stay with us, because it is towards evening, and the day is now far spent. And he went in with them. And it came to pass, whilst he was at table with them, he took bread, and blessed, and brake, and gave to them. And their eyes were opened, and they knew him: and he vanished out of their sight. And they said one to the other: Was not our heart burning within us, whilst he spoke in this way, and opened to us the scriptures?

And rising up, the same hour, they went back to Jerusalem: and they found the eleven gathered together,

and those that were staying with them, and how they knew him in the break-
saying: The Lord is risen indeed, and ing of the bread.
hath appeared to Simon. And they
told what things were done in the way;

Luke 24:13-35

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Week 9: Forgive Us our Trespasses

As we forgive those who trespass against us.

Each miracle of the Gospel of St. John is simultaneously a **teaching**, a **parable**, a **sign**, and an **event**.

Covenant of the Heart

Meditation: The seven miracles in John's gospel

These represent 7 stages of healing: the 7 stages of guilt and their forgiveness.

Creation and healing have to take place in reverse sequence: there, where the creation was completed, lies the starting point for the healing (i.e., restoring) effect. Accordingly, the prologue of the Gospel of St. John also gives the stages of Moses' account of creation (***light, life, man***) in the reverse sequence: "In him (the Word) was ***life, and the life was the light of men***" (John 1:1-4). The work of salvation takes place in reverse to that of the creation in so far as the last stage of the creation is the first of the work of salvation.

*Covenant of the Heart***II.1 Day 1: The Wedding at Cana**

On the third day there was a wedding in Cana in Galilee, and the mother of Jesus was there. Jesus and his disciples were also invited to the wedding. When the wine ran short, the mother of Jesus said to him, “They have no wine.” And Jesus said to her, “Woman, how does your concern affect me? My hour has not yet come.” His mother said to the servers, “Do whatever he tells you.” Now there were six stone water jars there for Jewish ceremonial washings, each holding twenty to thirty gallons. Jesus told them, “Fill the jars with water.” So they filled them to the brim. Then he told them, “Draw some out now and take it to the headwaiter.” So they took it. And when the headwaiter tasted the water that had become wine, without knowing where it came from (although the servers who had drawn the water knew), the headwaiter called the bridegroom and said to him, “Everyone serves good wine first, and then when people have drunk freely, an inferior one; but you have kept the good wine until now.” Jesus did this as the beginning of his signs in Cana in Galilee and so *revealed his glory, and his disciples began to believe in him.*

John 2:1-11

- **Guilt:** doubt
- **Sickness:** blood which had become lukewarm after the Fall
- **Forgiveness:** It is made fresh and vigorous. At the wedding, a new mixing of blood was taking place
- **Name of the Master:** I am the True Vine.

The wine at the wedding of Cana was not *created from* nothing, but rather it was *water* which was changed into wine. Let us also note the fact that the Virgin-Mother was not only present at the wedding but also that she took part in an explicit manner in the miracle of changing the water into wine — since it was thanks to her initiative that the miracle took place.

Meditations on the Tarot. Letter X: Force

The healing miracle work of the Word made flesh takes place in the reverse sequence to the creative miracle working of the divine Word depicted in Genesis. The divine magic of the seventh day becomes the first healing miracle of the Word made flesh, that of the wedding at Cana.

The free union, in love between God and the world, which was celebrated, blessed, and consecrated on the seventh day of creation, became broken off through the Fall. The world was unfaithful toward God. And since this divine cosmic union is mirrored in the marriage relationship, for which it is the ideal and archetype as well as being the meaning of marriage, the original sickness of the world consists in the breach of the free love union that existed between God and the world. Analogously, this is mirrored in human life, in the distortion and degeneration of the nature and experience of marriage. The marriage relationship — as it has become — begins with enthusiasm, with the “wine” of the honeymoon period, and ends with the “water” of routine habit.

When there was no more wine, Jesus transformed water into wine, and the second wine was better than the first. Thereby the miracle of the wedding at Cana was the “sign,” the symbol, and the event of the healing of marriage (healing in the service of restoring the marriage relationship to correspond to its divine cosmic archetype, which is the seventh day of creation).

Covenant of the Heart

II.2 Day 2: Healing of the Nobleman's Son

He came again therefore into Cana of Galilee, where he made the water wine. And there was a certain ruler, whose son was sick at Capharnaum. He having heard that Jesus was come from Judea into Galilee, went to him, and prayed him to come down, and heal his son; for he was at the point of death.

Jesus therefore said to him: Unless you see signs and wonders, you believe not.

The ruler saith to him: Lord, come down before that my son die.

Jesus saith to him: Go thy way; thy son liveth. The man believed the word which Jesus said to him, and went his way.

And as he was going down, his servants met him; and they brought word, saying, that his son lived. He asked therefore of them the hour wherein he grew better. And they said to him: Yesterday, at the seventh hour, the fever left him. The father therefore knew, that it was at the same hour that Jesus said to him, Thy son liveth; and himself believed, and his whole house. This is again the second miracle that Jesus did, when he was come out of Judea into Galilee.

John 4:46-54

- **Guilt:** desire
- **Sickness:** the sin of the change of heredity from the vertical to the horizontal
- **Forgiveness:** The father bore the guilt for the son's illness. The father believed and the son was healed.
- **Name of the Master:** I am the Way, the Truth, the Life.

The sixth day of Creation

The sixth day of creation in Genesis is an account of the origin of the animal kingdom and the human being, corresponding to their archetype:

- The archetype of the human being is God: God created humans in God's own image, in the image of God, God created them.
- The animals were brought forth from the earth formed by God, each according to its kind.

Heredity

Heredity means the transmission of similarity from ancestors to their descendants. The archetypal nature of heredity is vertical: the archetype is above and the form mirroring it is shaped below, on earth. Thus, the invisible divinely created archetypes are the "ancestors" of the visible species of animals. And the invisible archetype of man, the divine being itself, is the "ancestor" of the human being.

The sickness that arose as a tragic consequence of the Fall was a change of direction in the mirroring process of heredity; it changed from being vertical to become horizontal. This meant that similarity no longer descended from the invisible supratemporal archetype above, but from the visible ancestors in the temporal succession of generations here below.

The Sin of Heredity

The *sickness* that arose as a tragic consequence of the Fall was a change of direction in the mirroring process of heredity; it changed from being vertical to become horizontal. This meant that similarity no longer descended from the invisible supratemporal archetype above, but from the visible ancestors in the temporal succession of generations here below.

Instead of becoming the direct "image and likeness" of their archetype, human beings and other beings of nature became formed in the "image and likeness" of their earthly ancestors, thus only indirectly mirroring their archetype. Thereby heredity, as we know it, became a horizontal stream in the sequence of time, transmitting not only the original mirroring of the archetype, but also everything that entered into the stream

of generations with the Fall and that has occurred in this stream since the Fall. It has become a stream that also transmits the “sins” of sickness and death, and through it the “sins of the fathers” have become a reality.

The Healing

The second miracle of the Gospel of St. John, the healing of the nobleman’s son, where the healing of the son took place through the faith of the father, was fulfilled, like the first, at Cana in Galilee. It comprises the transformation of the relationship father—son (i.e., heredity) from being a stream transmitting sickness to a stream transmitting healing. The second miracle of the John Gospel is the event, sign, and teaching, which has to do with the divine archetypal heredity of the sixth day of creation. It has to do with the distortion of this “vertical” heredity through the Fall, in that the original relationship to the “image and likeness of God,” as it was on the sixth day of creation, was restored by the father bringing his son into a direct relationship to the divine archetype—through his faith in Jesus Christ, the new Adam.

He brought his son into connection with the new Adam, who, in place of himself, entered into the hereditary relationship “father-son.” Thus the healing of the nobleman’s son took place.

Covenant of the Heart

II.3 Day 3: Healing of the Paralyzed Man

After these things was a festival day of the Jews, and Jesus went up to Jerusalem. Now there is at Jerusalem a pond, called Probatica, which in Hebrew is named Bethesda, having five porches. In these lay a great multitude of sick, of blind, of lame, of withered; waiting for the moving of the water. And an angel of the Lord descended at certain times into the pond; and the water was moved. And he that went down first into

the pond after the motion of the water, was made whole, of whatsoever infirmity he lay under. And there was a certain man there, that had been eight and thirty years under his infirmity. Him when Jesus had seen lying, and knew that he had been now a long time, he saith to him: Wilt thou be made whole?

The infirm man answered him: Sir, I have no man, when the water is troubled, to put me into the pond. For whilst I am coming, another goeth down before me. Jesus saith to him: Arise, take up thy bed, and walk. And immediately the man was made whole: and he took up his bed, and walked. And it was the sabbath that day.

John 5:1-9

- **Guilt:** cutting oneself from the cosmic current
- **Sickness:** paralysis
- **Forgiveness:** The restoration of movement
- **Name of the Master:** I am the door

The fifth day of Creation

The fifth day of creation in Genesis is the account of the waters bringing forth ensouled movement:

- in the **horizontal** direction: swarms of living creatures
- in the vertical direction: birds that fly above the earth across the firmament of the heavens

The Healing

The result of the third miracle in the Gospel of St. John is the healing of the man who was paralyzed for thirty-eight years, i.e., the restoration of ensouled faculty of movement to the paralyzed man, who lay there

waiting for healing through the water brought into movement by an angel.

The words of Jesus –*Arise, take up thy bed and walk*– create ensouled movement in:

- The vertical direction: *arise*
- The horizontal direction: take up thy bed and *walk*

The faculty of movement is essentially cosmic, not only according to its effect, where every movement, even the slightest, exerts an effect ultimately upon the whole world, but also according to the causes stimulating it. For the human being stands within a stream of cosmic energies—his thoughts in the streams of the thought world, his feelings in the streams of the world’s psychic forces, and his impulses of will are immersed in the streams of world will energy and are “plugged in” to them.

Someone who cuts himself off from the streams of cosmic energies becomes paralyzed.

The third miracle of the John Gospel accomplished the “re-plugging in” of this human being into the ensouled movement of the world, who, through sin, had become cut off from it and thereby paralyzed. The third miracle is the archetype of the healing effect of the sacrament of the forgiveness of sins, i.e., penance.

Covenant of the Heart

II.4 Day 4: Feeding of the Five Thousand

After these things Jesus went over the sea of Galilee, which is that of Tiberias. And a great multitude followed him, because they saw the miracles which he did on them that were diseased. Jesus therefore went up

into a mountain, and there he sat with his disciples. Now the pasch, the festival day of the Jews, was near at hand.

When Jesus therefore had lifted up his eyes, and seen that a very great multitude cometh to him, he said to Philip: Whence shall we buy bread, that these may eat? And this he said to try him; for he himself knew what he would do.

Philip answered him: Two hundred pennyworth of bread is not sufficient for them, that every one may take a little.

One of his disciples, Andrew, the brother of Simon Peter, saith to him: There is a boy here that hath five barley loaves, and two fishes; but what are these among so many?

Then Jesus said: Make the men sit down. Now there was much grass in the place. The men therefore sat down, in number about five thousand. And Jesus took the loaves: and when he had given thanks, he distributed to them that were set down. In like manner also of the fishes, as much as they would. And when they were filled, he said to his disciples: Gather up the fragments that remain, lest they be lost.

They gathered up therefore, and filled twelve baskets with the fragments of the five barley loaves, which remained over and above to them that had eaten. Now those men, when they had seen what a miracle Jesus had done, said: This is of a truth the prophet, that is to come into the world.

John 6:1-14

- **Guilt:** egoism
- **Sickness:** cutting oneself from the community
- **Forgiveness:** The reinstatement of the original community of beings
- **Name of the Master:** I am the bread of life

Fourth Day of Creation

The fourth day of creation “stands before” the “play” of the many kinds of spontaneous movement of the fifth day and “leads” it. For the fourth day of creation is that of the coming into being of those principles of the world orchestra that direct “time and tempo” — the creation of the “sun, moon, and stars”: “And God made two great lights: the greater light to rule the day and the lesser light to rule the night; he made stars also; and God set them in the firmament of the heavens to separate the day from the night and let them be for signs and for seasons and for days and years”. What are these other than organs of direction, i.e., conductors of time and tempo for the world orchestra, in accordance with the music score of the stars?

The fourth day of creation is the genesis of that all-embracing world rhythm, in which all beings partake and that unifies them into a world-embracing community. Consider human consciousness. It does not become chaotic through the strife of wishes, desires, whims, moods, notions, and countless impulses from without and within—from fantasy and from memory. Rather, it arranges itself around a central point, the self, which represents the center of gravity of the soul life, i.e., the permanency of the identity of the personality.

Moreover, aided by the light of reason it works in such a way as to bring order even into the “night” of the subconscious, leading the whole soul life (conscious and unconscious, or “day” and “night”) in the direction of the ideals. (Ideals can be likened to “stars,” enabling orientation and pointing the way.)

This “sun” leads and supports the whole—the “day world” and also the “night world”—in harmony with the world of stars. The sun (or rather the inner nature of the sun) in the great world corresponds to the creative, leading, and ordering role of the self in the “small world” of the human soul. The moon in its inner nature corresponds to the rational capacity for reflection, which casts an evaluating light on the irrational

urges of the soul life. The inner nature of the stars in the great world correspond to the ideals that give direction to human soul life.

The fourth day of creation is the account of the origin of the universal community, of the unity embracing all beings of the world. It is therefore the divine cosmic archetype of the sacrament upon the altar, that of holy communion.

The Fourth Miracle

The feeding of the five thousand in the wilderness —is the corresponding healing work of the Word made flesh. This work consisted in the reinstatement of the original community of beings from the fourth day of creation, and the corresponding ordering given on this day of creation by the sun, moon, and stars. For as the Sun — raying out light, warmth, and life — “nourishes” all beings and unites them in a “community of nourishment,” so Jesus Christ functioned at the feeding of the five thousand as the “nourishment giving center” for the five thousand.

II.5 Day 5: Jesus Walks on Water

The fifth miracle of St. John’s Gospel is the “sign” of individual generative power as it came into being on the third day of creation.

The third day of creation is the “day” of procreation, of the mystery of seed and of growth.

And when evening was come, his disciples went down to the sea. And when they had gone up into a ship, they went over the sea to Capernaum; and it was now dark, and Jesus was not come unto them. And the sea arose, by reason of a great wind that blew. When they had rowed therefore about five and twenty or thirty furlongs, they see Jesus walking upon the sea, and drawing nigh to the ship, and they were afraid.

But he said to them: **It is I; be not afraid.** They were willing therefore to take him into the ship; and presently the ship was at the land to which they were going.

John 6:16-21

- **Guilt:** lack of faith
- **Sickness:** separation from the instinctual life, the power of the seed principle
- **Forgiveness:** the restoration of pure faith, unsupported by anything but inner certainty
- **Name of the Master:** I am the good shepherd

Third Day of Creation

And God said: Let the earth bring forth grass, plants yielding seed, and fruit trees each bearing fruit after its kind, whose seed is in itself upon the earth; and it was so. And the earth brought forth grass, and plants yielding seed each according to its kind, and trees bearing fruit, whose seed was in itself after its kind.

Genesis 1:11

The third day of creation is the generation of the seed principle, of the principle of potential formative force becoming actualised and bringing to visible realisation its own inner, invisible shape. The third day of creation is the coming into being of the seed principle in the world—that is, not only of the plant world manifest to us as plants and trees, but also such “trees” growing in paradise as “the tree of knowledge of good and evil” and the “tree of life.” Also included here is all that grew out of the “seed of Abraham,” and that in the New Testament that, as the Kingdom of God, was sown as “seed” and shall in the future become a mighty tree. The words of Jesus, too, that fell on hard or on good ground and bear fruit accordingly—all these belong in the realm of the seed principle that came into being on the third day of creation.

The language of the Bible is neither merely realistic, nor merely symbolic. It is real symbolic, i.e., instead of employing abstract concepts it makes use of real facts, each corresponding to a principle embodying a basic and essential truth. Therefore the trees of which “each bore fruit after its kind, whose seed was in itself” were not just ash trees and oak trees, but also the tree of knowledge and the tree of life. And the fruit of the tree of knowledge bears the seed of death; the tree of life, on the other hand, bears the seed of an uninterrupted metamorphosis of growth.

The biblical words: seed, trees, the sea, and the dry land, as also heaven and earth, mean much more than the concrete things designated by these words. The “seas” that in Genesis’ account of the third day of creation are described as “the gathering together of the waters under the heavens unto one place” signify the state of concentration (“gathering”) of force substance, whereby it retains its mobility in the sense of being able to be moved. On the other hand, the “dry land” means a state of still greater concentration (“gathering unto one place”), where the force substance is so condensed that a coagulation into solidity is reached.

Covenant of the Heart

The Fifth Miracle

The miracle of the walking on the water—as an event and as a “sign”—is the revelation of the independence of the Son of Man with regard to the sea and the land. Jesus Christ walking on the sea needs no support, for he supports himself.

The Word revealed by the walking on the water is the creative Word of the third day of creation. It is the Word that lies at the basis of the seed principle. Just as the seed determines the future ways and stages of growth, so the Good Shepherd decides the ways of development of the true being of humanity and leads it along these ways.

The third day of creation is the divine cosmic background of the sacrament of confirmation.

Covenant of the Heart

Peter answered him: Lord, if it is you, bid me come to you on the water. He said: Come! So Peter got out of the boat and walked on the water and came to Jesus. But when he saw the wind, he was afraid, and beginning to sink he cried out: Lord, save me! Jesus immediately reached out his hand and caught him, saying to him: O man of little faith, why did you doubt?

Matthew 14:28-31

Fear is due to the menace of being engulfed by elemental forces of gravitation of a lower order, i.e. of being carried away by the play of blind forces from the agitated “sea” of the “electrical field” of death. “I am; be not afraid” is therefore the message of the centre, or Master, of celestial gravitation.

There is another field of gravitation than that of death, and he who unites himself with it can walk on water, i.e., transcend the agitated element of “this world”, the electrical gravitational field of the serpent.

He got out of the boat, which means — in view of all the laws of reason and memory — that he was taken out of the domain of ordinary consciousness, i.e., that of reason, memory, and sense perception, and he walked on the water, drawn by Jesus. He experienced, therefore, the same elevation of the soul which draws the body up after it as spoken of by St. Teresa.

Meditations on the Tarot. Letter XII: The Hanged Man

II.6 Day 6: Healing of the Man born Blind

The basis of man's destiny is the decision to renounce the sight that is blind to the revelations of the Divine, and to wait for the miracle of the reinstatement of the true, original faculty of beholding that sees all things visible as "works of God revealed."

The second day of creation is the creation of the firmament, dividing the waters that were under the firmament from the waters that were above the firmament.

And Jesus passing by, saw a man, who was blind from his birth. And his disciples asked him: Rabbi, who hath sinned, this man, or his parents, that he should be born blind?

Jesus answered: Neither hath this man sinned, nor his parents; but that the works of God should be made manifest in him. I must work the works of him that sent me, whilst it is day: the night cometh, when no man can work. As long as I am in the world, I am the light of the world.

When he had said these things, he spat on the ground, and made clay of the spittle, and spread the clay on his eyes, and said to him: Go, wash in the pool of Siloam, which means "Sent". He went therefore, and washed, and he came seeing.

John 9:1-7

- **Guilt:** shame
- **Sickness:** separation from the light
- **Forgiveness:** the true, original vision is restored
- **Name of the Master:** I am the light of the world

Second Day of Creation

The second day of creation is the creation of the firmament, dividing the waters that were under the firmament from the waters that were above

the firmament. “And God called the firmament heaven.” **It is the “day” of the coming into being of “vision,” of knowledge, of true gnosis.** For the “firmament” or “heaven” that divides the waters above from those below is the “light” of the first day of Genesis — which now not only divides the waters above from those below, but is also the connecting link between them.

The waters below mirror the heavens, and likewise the waters above mirror them. This double reflection is the principle of vision, of knowledge itself, for knowledge is the transformation of the seen into insight, of what is perceived into truth. It is the realization of the connection between things and ideas, between the real and the ideal.

Now, the reflection of the heavens in the waters below is the realm of things (“the real”), while ideas (“the ideal”) are represented by the reflection of the heavens in the waters above. And knowledge, or understanding, is the process of relating the real to the ideal corresponding to it. The active, creatively functioning light (of “heaven”) is reflected both above as ideas and also below as realities.

The **light** that forms the firmament of heaven and that is reflected both in the waters above the firmament and also in the waters below the firmament is the Logos, the Word, by which all things were made.

Covenant of the Heart

Sixth Miracle

The Word bore witness to himself through the lips of Jesus Christ at the sixth miracle of St. John’s Gospel — the healing of the man born blind — “As long as I am in the world, I am the **light** of the world”

The Logos is not only the intelligence of the world, that is, the connection of the ideal with the real, but also the perception of the ideal and the real. All seeing, hearing, touching, etc., presupposes an intermediate

connecting link, an organ, between the percept (the object of perception) and the perceiver (the subject of perception).

The miracle of the healing of the man born blind is a pure act of God. It does not presuppose a willingness to repent, nor any act of faith on the part of the man born blind. For neither had the man born blind sinned in his life before birth in the spiritual world or in a previous life on earth, nor had the sin of his parents caused his blindness. The cause lay in the future. He was born blind “that the works of God might be made manifest in him.”

Through the Fall vision became horizontal, i.e., the “lower eye” became the sole organ of seeing, then “Adam and Eve saw that they were naked.” This means that vision became devoid of ideas, a perception of the “bare facts,” i.e., of facts alone, without the corresponding ideas in the waters above the firmament. It became basically cynical.

It was this vision, limited to the bare facts, which the man born blind had renounced at the time of his pre-birth choice of destiny, in order that the true, original vision—the vision of the real combined with the ideal, as prefigured on the second day of creation—might be reinstated in him.

The **sixth miracle** is the archetype of the sacrament of ordination, the sacrament of the regeneration of original and true vision.

Covenant of the Heart

11.7 Day 7: The Raising of Lazarus

Reading: John 11:1-44

The first day of creation is the genesis of the world in its seed condition, i.e., with all its latent possibilities.

The Lazarus miracle is that of the calling forth of light out of darkness.

- GUILT: losing consciousness
- SICKNESS: excess of spirituality
- FORGIVENESS: all the previous miracles
- NAME OF THE MASTER: I am the resurrection and the life

First Day of Creation

The “days” that follow the first are those of unfolding and actualizing in detail what had been created as a foundation on the first day. The account of the following days represents a kind of explanatory commentary on the first day of creation. The miracle of the first day embraces and contains in itself the whole miracle of creation in essence.

The account of the first day of creation is the beginning of the beginnings, i.e., the theme and principle of creation. It is not a question of what is first in time, but of the deepest and highest foundations of existence — of the primal foundation (in the sense of the archetypal ground) underlying the world.

The text of Genesis concerning the first day of creation must be read in the deeper language of spiritual morality. We must comprehend it not as an allegory, but as a concrete moral spiritual happening.

God allowed two tendencies, two impulses, to proceed in opposite directions: in the direction “above” and in the direction “below.” There is the striving to be a “likeness” of God (Heaven) and the striving to give oneself up to God, to mirror Him, to be an “image” of God (Earth).

The world was sunk in sleep; it breathed, but was unconscious. The darkness over the deep is absence of reflection, i.e., unconsciousness. The creative primal words: “Let there be light,” are the awakening words for the sleeping world. It signifies the same as “wake up,” the act of waking, or awaking consciousness. The sleeping world wrapped in darkness was awakened to consciousness by the words “let there be light”; the “waters” began to reflect and the “earth” was no longer formless and void. The

spirits of the hierarchies were awakened out of the sleep of their “rest in God,” and so there was **light**, the **consciousness** of the world.

Seventh Miracle

The Lazarus miracle signifies the awakening of consciousness for all that is relative — relative for the soul immersed in “rest in the Absolute,” in the sleep of death. This miracle at the same time encompasses the six preceding miracles, for Lazarus was not only a soul and spirit who was called back; he was also a corpse — that is, blind, deaf, and without movement. Thus each miracle was repeated in his case:

- the miracle of the healing of the man born blind
- the miracle of the reinstatement of an independent bearing (the walking on the water)
- the miracle of nourishment, i.e., the regeneration of the used up and devastated organic substances of the body (the miracle of the feeding of the five thousand)
- the miracle of the reinstatement of movement (the healing of the paralysed man)
- the miracle of the healing of sickness (which in this case had led to death) through the regeneration of “vertical heredity” issuing from the new Adam (the healing of the nobleman’s son)
- the miracle of the changing of water into wine, by which the liquids in the body were transformed into circulating warm blood.

Just as the first day of creation in essence contains and encompasses the entire account of the creation, so does the seventh miracle of St. John’s Gospel contain and encompass the other six miracles. It is the archetype of the sacrament of extreme unction,

the sacrament for the dying, which is directed toward future resurrection — thereby in essence containing and encompassing the other six sacraments.

Covenant of the Heart

Posted on 2023-04-10 by Cologero

II.8 Afterword

Dear reader,

here comes to an end this *Our Father Course*. Shortly after the last post, God called his servant Cologero from this earth, and thus the work remains unfinished.

II.9 Week 10: Lead us not into Temptation

Humanity is faced with three temptations, just as Jesus was tempted in the wilderness.

1. Materialism, or the temptation to turn stones into bread. This is the understanding of the universe as Being, not the universe of the Good or Love. Dead matter somehow creates life and consciousness, not to mention spiritual experience. In popular films and TV shows, we see computerized robots turn into sentient beings.
2. The desire to plunge into the subconscious as the source of spiritual life. This ignores all higher forces, the superconscious and divine revelation as the true source of religion.
3. The denial of causality attributes events to chance or to random variation. This absolves human beings from the responsibility of their own future.

The chakras, or lotus flowers, lie at the foundation of the human being. Temptation is the wrong unfolding of the lotus flowers. Christ's transfiguration illumines the chakras. The I AM sayings correspond to different chakra.

The Old Testament describes the six days of creation culminating in the Old Adam.

The New Testament begins with the description of the birth and growth of the new humanity, the New Adam.

Day 1: The Temptation in Paradise

First Fall I AM: the resurrection and the life

Reading: Genesis chapter 3

Chakra: Crown Chakra

The temptation in Paradise was the fall into death. The 8-petalled lotus, the Crown chakra, is Union with God. But in Eden this union was destroyed and the Crown chakra represented death.

The temptation first came to Eve, the psychic and astral human element. The intellectual element, or the "I" then succumbed to the temptation. Hence, egoism entered into the stream of humanity.

Transfiguration

Jesus said: I am the resurrection, and the life: he that believeth in me, though he were dead, yet shall he live. (John 11:25)

And it came to pass about eight days after these sayings, he took Peter and John and James, and went up into a mountain to pray. And as he prayed, the fashion of his countenance was altered, and his raiment was white and glistering. And, behold, there talked with him two men, which were Moses and Elias: Who appeared in glory, and spake of his decease which he should accomplish at Jerusalem. But Peter and they that were with him were heavy with

sleep: and when they were awake, they saw his glory, and the two men that stood with him.

And it came to pass, as they departed from him, Peter said unto Jesus, Master, it is good for us to be here: and let us make three tabernacles; one for thee, and one for Moses, and one for Elias: not knowing what he said. While he thus spake, there came a cloud, and overshadowed them: and they feared as they entered into the cloud. And there came a voice out of the cloud, saying, This is my beloved Son: hear him. (Luke 9:28-36)

Christ radiated Divine Love into human nature on Mount Tabor.

Day 2: The Sons of God

Second Fall I AM: the light of the world

Reading: Genesis chapter 6:1-6

And it came to pass, when men began to multiply on the face of the earth, and daughters were born unto them. That the sons of God saw the daughters of men that they were attractive; and they took them wives of all which they chose. And the Lord said, My spirit shall not always strive with man, for that he also is flesh: yet his days shall be an hundred and twenty years. There were giants in the earth in those days; and also after that, when the sons of God came in unto the daughters of men, and they bare children to them, the same became mighty men which were of old, men of renown. And God saw that the wickedness of man was great in the earth, and that every imagination of the thoughts of his heart was only evil continually. and it repented the Lord that he had made man on the earth, and it grieved him at his heart.

Chakra: Ajna Chakra, the two-petalled lotus flower.

The sons of God were the righteous ones. They were attracted to the daughters of men, i.e., the profane who were strangers to God. The effect is that they lost the double vision, i.e., they did not see the vertical dimension, but only the horizontal, which came from the outside. In other words, they judged solely by appearances, and not by spiritual qualities or essences.

The distorted the two-petaled lotus flower of the head, or Ajna, chakra.

The distorted Ajna chakra, the seat of the intellect, no longer reflects the light, but lives in darkness and tries to understand the world without reference to higher things.

Transfiguration

Then spake Jesus again unto them, saying, I am the light of the world: he that followeth me shall not walk in darkness, but shall have the light of life. (John 8:12)

The Master opens up the Ajna chakra to the light of the fire principle of Love, so that the intellect can reflect it. Vertical vision from above is restored so that the essential can be distinguished from the inessential.

Day 3: The Tower of Babel

Third Fall I AM: the good shepherd

Reading: Genesis 11:1-9

And the whole earth was of one language, and of one speech. And it came to pass, as they journeyed from the east, that they found a plain in the land of Shinar; and they dwelt there. And they said one to another, Go to, let us make brick, and burn them thoroughly. And they had brick for stone, and slime had they for mortar. And they said, Go to, let us build us a city and a tower,

whose top may reach unto heaven; and let us make us a name, lest we be scattered abroad upon the face of the whole earth.

And the Lord came down to see the city and the tower, which the children of men builded. And the Lord said, Behold, the people is one, and they have all one language; and this they begin to do: and now nothing will be restrained from them, which they have imagined to do. Go to, let us go down, and there confound their language, that they may not understand one another's speech. So the Lord scattered them abroad from thence upon the face of all the earth: and they left off to build the city.

Therefore is the name of it called Babel; because the Lord did there confound the language of all the earth: and from thence did the Lord scatter them abroad upon the face of all the earth.

Chakra: Throat Chakra

The 16-petalled Throat Chakra is associated with speech. The hubris of the human beings resulted in its destruction. Hence, The universal language of humanity became confounded into multiple languages.

The primal, total breathing of humanity corresponded to the original, universal language of humanity. Speech is the formation of the breath into sound. The loss of the single universal human language after the building of the tower of Babel signified the disappearance of the primal, total breathing, which became individual and arbitrary. And the Whitsun miracle, where the apostles spoke a single language, which was understood by human beings from different lands as if it were their own, was a resurrection of the primal breathing and the original language of humanity.

The original language spoken prior to the building of the tower of Babel was also total. It was more than a mere communication of information. Rather, it was a kind of thought transmission (telepathy), which had the effect of awakening insight, instead of simply informing. It served to awaken insight and understanding, rather than explaining things. It

communicated an intimation of things. Not that the intimations were indefinite, having multiple meanings that had to be explained.

No, they were like rays or bolts of lightning bearing light and clarity within them. Both the speaker and the listener partook of this light, which came from the depths of the heart and penetrated into the depths of the heart—a kind of “heart magic.” This was also so with the speaking of the apostles at Whitsun, which was experienced by all those from different countries as their mother tongue. For what could be closer to each human being than the language of the heart?

At the root of the building of the tower of Babel is the collective will of “lower selves” to achieve the replacing of the “true Self of the celestial hierarchies and God with a superstructure of universal significance fabricated through this will.

The building of the tower of Babel had as its effect the “thunderbolt” of the “descent of the Lord”, who “confused their language” — that of the builders — and “scattered them abroad over the face of all the earth”, so that they would no longer understand one another’s language.

He who rebels against his “higher Self will no longer live under the law of the vertical but. rather under that of the horizontal, i.e. he will be “a fugitive and a wanderer on the earth.” (Lazarus come forth)

Transfiguration

I am the good shepherd, and know my sheep, and am known of mine. (John 10:14)

Christ heals the Throat Chakra when all the sheep from different folds hear his voice and understand.

And other sheep I have, which are not of this fold: them also I must bring, and they shall hear my voice; and there shall be one fold, and one shepherd.

All those who were confused and scattered are joined together.

This was confirmed at Whitsun when the disciples all understood each other's language.

At Pentecost his disciples realised the universal and eternal truth of the identity of all individual “selves” in the higher universal Self—which is manifested by the fact that their speech became that of the higher Self of each person who listened to them. (MotT)

Day 4: Changing Stones into Bread

Fourth Fall I AM: the bread of life

Reading: Luke 4:1-4, Matthew 4:1-4

And Jesus being full of the Holy Ghost returned from Jordan, and was led by the Spirit into the wilderness, Being forty days tempted of the devil. And in those days he did eat nothing: and when they were ended, he afterward hungered. And the devil said unto him, If thou be the Son of God, command this stone that it be made bread. And Jesus answered him, saying, It is written, That man shall not live by bread alone, but by every word of God.

Chakra: Heart Chakra, the twelve-petaled lotus flower

The “heart” that we have in mind here is not that of emotion and the faculty of being passionate that one generally understands by “heart”. This centre is the most human of all the centres of “lotus flowers”; it is the chakra of love.

At the center of the seven chakras, it is the bridge between Heaven above and the Earth below.

Temptation The temptation to turn stones into bread manifests in humanity as the temptation to explain:

- quality by means of quantity

- the living by means of the dead or mechanical
- to fashion qualitative “living” things out of quantitative mechanical ones

The temptation to be nourished by “stones”, i.e., dead things, destroyed the heart chakra.

Transfiguration Chakra work consisted in the attempt to awaken the chakras as they are.

Our task now is the Christianisation of all the centres, i.e. their transformation in conformity with their divine-human prototypes.

The work of Christianisation of the human organisation, i.e. the transformation of the human being into a man of heart, is accomplished in the inner life of man, the lotus-flowers being only the field where the effects of this purely inner work are manifested.

Rather than by stones, we need to be nourished by the bread of life.

Day 5: Descending into the Unconscious

Fifth Fall I AM: the door.

Reading: Luke 4:9-13, Matthew 4:5-7, Luke 9:28-36, John 10:7-16

And he brought him to Jerusalem, and set him on a pinnacle of the temple, and said unto him, If thou be the Son of God, cast thyself down from hence: For it is written, He shall give his angels charge over thee, to keep thee: And in their hands they shall bear thee up, lest at any time thou dash thy foot against a stone. And Jesus answering said unto him, It is said, Thou shalt not tempt the Lord thy God. And when the devil had ended all the temptation, he departed from him for a season.

Chakra: Solar Plexus Chakra, the ten-petaled lotus flower

The three lower chakras are organs of horizontal perception, what St. Theresa called “imaginary vision”.

As the ten-petaled lotus underlies the senses, it is also the chakra of science, which studies the world revealed to the senses.

Temptation The second temptation in the wilderness is to succumb to the instinctual life, that is, to plummet down from the spiritual heights to the unconscious.

Transfiguration Light drives out darkness. This simple truth is the practical key to the problem of how to combat demons. A demon perceived, i.e. on whom the light of consciousness is thrown, is already a demon rendered impotent.

And when he went forth to land, there met him out of the city a certain man, which had devils long time, and ware no clothes, neither abode in any house, but in the tombs. When he saw Jesus, he cried out, and fell down before him, and with a loud voice said, What have I to do with thee, Jesus, thou Son of God most high? I beseech thee, torment me not. (For he had commanded the unclean spirit to come out of the man. For oftentimes it had caught him: and he was kept bound with chains and in fetters; and he brake the bands, and was driven of the devil into the wilderness.)

And Jesus asked him, saying, What is thy name? And he said, Legion: because many devils were entered into him. And they besought him that he would not command them to go out into the deep. And there was there a herd of many swine feeding on the mountain: and they besought him that he would suffer them to enter into them. And he suffered them. Then went the devils out of the man, and entered into the swine: and the herd ran violently down a steep place into the lake, and were choked.

When they that fed them saw what was done, they fled, and went and told it in the city and in the country. Then they went out to see what was done; and came to Jesus, and found the man, out of whom the devils were departed, sitting at the feet of Jesus, clothed, and in his right mind: and they were afraid. They also which saw it told them by what means he that was possessed of the devils was healed.

Here we see that Christ not only drives out the demons but makes them visible in the herd of swine. That is, the demons had dwelled in the unconscious, but exposing them to the Light of Christ brought the man to his right mind.

In MotT, Tomberg explains:

Modern depth psychology has discovered and put into practice the therapeutic principle of bringing unconscious complexes to the light of consciousness. Because—so it affirms—the light of consciousness renders the obsessional complex not only visible but also impotent. This important discovery of modern psychology is in complete accord with the spiritual reality of the “struggle” of the celestial hierarchies against evil. Because this “struggle”, also, amounts to their presence alone, i.e. to bringing evil to the light of day.

Day 6: The Will to Power

Sixth Fall I AM: the way, the truth and the life.

Reading: Luke 4:5-8, Matthew 4:8-10, Luke 9:28-36, John 14:6

And the devil, taking him up into an high mountain, shewed unto him all the kingdoms of the world in a moment of time. And the devil said unto him, All this power will I give thee, and the glory of them: for that is delivered unto me; and to whomsoever I will

I give it. If thou therefore wilt worship me, all shall be thine. And Jesus answered and said unto him, Get thee behind me, Satan: for it is written, Thou shalt worship the Lord thy God, and him only shalt thou serve.

Chakra: Sacral Chakra, the six-petaled lotus flower

The chakra is the center of Harmony and Health.

Under the influence of the Heart Chakra, the six-petalled lotus will become that of holiness, i.e. harmony between spirit, soul and body. One of the powers obtained from meditating on this chakra is eloquence and clarity, in words and thoughts.

Temptation The harmony of spirit, soul, and body is also the harmony of the physical, astral, and spiritual world. The temptation to power in the physical, material world destroys the sacral chakra by separating the being from the higher worlds.

Transfiguration Christ's words heal this chakra: I AM

- The Way: Heals the Body
- The Truth: Heals the Soul
- The Life: Heals the Spirit

This saying results in inner harmony. In the future, as the spiritual penetrates more deeply into the physical world, humanity will become healthier.

Day 7: The Night of Gethsemane

Seventh Fall **I AM:** the true vine.

Reading: Luke 22:39-46, Matthew 26:36-46, Mark 14:32-42 Luke 9:28-36, John 15:1-9

And they said, Lord, behold, here are two swords. And he said unto them, It is enough. And he came out, and went, as he was wont, to the mount of Olives; and his disciples also followed him. And when he was at the place, he said unto them, Pray that ye enter not into temptation. And he was withdrawn from them about a stone's cast, and kneeled down, and prayed, Saying, Father, if thou be willing, remove this cup from me: nevertheless, not my will, but thine, be done. And there appeared an angel unto him from heaven, strengthening him. And being in an agony he prayed more earnestly: and his sweat was as it were great drops of blood falling down to the ground. And when he rose up from prayer, and was come to his disciples, he found them sleeping for sorrow, And said unto them, Why sleep ye? rise and pray, lest ye enter into temptation.

Chakra: Root Chakra, the four-petaled lotus flower
The center of creative force

Temptation The apostles slept while Jesus prayed. They descended into the unconscious in which was the center of their being. The root chakra wants to be autonomous.

Unchastity is nothing other than the autonomy of carnal desire, so that the wholeness of the human being— in spirit, soul and body—is ruined. Sexual desire is only one aspect of love —the aspect reflected by that part of the physical and psychic organism which is the special domain of the “four-petalled lotus”—and it constitutes only one-seventh of the human psychic-physical organism. (from MotT)

Transfiguration The human being is fundamentally what his heart is. When he is awakened, he is centered in the heart. The man of heart is a man who has regained his humanity. The three lower chakras will be aligned to the heart.

Then the creative force of the four-petalled lotus will then serve as a source of energy and inexhaustible élan.

Posted by Cologero

II.10 Week II: Deliver Us from Evil

Meditation: The 7 Words from the Cross

Crucifixion: The humanization, or awakening of the chakras, such as they are

Illumination: The Christianisation of the chakras

Among the effects of this illumination is *certainty*: (from MotT)

- The three higher lotuses are those of infused certainty or “imperceptible light”, and these are the principal instruments of “intellectual vision” or trans-subjective revelation.
- The three lower lotuses are those of certainty of experience at first hand: they render us “eye-witnesses” to invisible things. They manifest them to us in “perceptible light” as forms, movements, colours, sounds and breath — concrete and objective — although incorporeal in the sense of the physical world.
- The central centre, the heart or twelve-petalled lotus, gives us the certainty of authentic faith.

Evil: The chakras are not in harmony. Thus they work independently and the lower chakras try to dominate consciousness and the higher

chakras are unaware of their transcendence source. The human being is fundamentally what his heart is, and the heart is not oriented to the divine.

The great work of spiritual alchemy is the transmutation of the substances (“metals”) of the other lotuses into the substance of the heart (“gold”).

Day 1: I commend my spirit **Words:** Father, into Thy hands, I commend my Spirit.

Reading: Luke 23:46, Mark 15:37

And when Jesus had cried with a loud voice, he said, *Father, into thy hands I commend my spirit*: and having said thus, he gave up the ghost.

Chakra: Crown Chakra, the eight-petaled lotus flower

The eight-petaled lotus is the centre of wisdom and is used by the Spirit.

Undeveloped, it is abstract.

When the Heart is developed, it will become full of warmth, like the fire of Pentecost.

To the extent that concentration in the crown chakra takes place, vital activity diminishes — at first in the lower region of the organism, i.e. the genital and intestinal region, then in the region of the stomach, and lastly in the central region in the neighbourhood of the heart. At the moment when the concentration of vitality at the crown centre is complete, the heart and also the circulatory and respiratory system cease their activity — **this is the moment of death.**

Day 2: Why hast thou forsaken me **Words:** My God, my god, Why hast thou forsaken me?

Reading: Matthew 27:45-46, Mark 15:34

Now from the sixth hour there was darkness over all the land unto the ninth hour. And about the ninth hour Jesus cried with a loud voice, saying, Eli, Eli, lama sabachthani? that is to say, *My God, my God, why hast thou forsaken me?*

Chakra: Ajna Chakra, the two-petalled lotus flower

The two-petalled lotus is the centre of intellectual initiative and concentration.

Undeveloped, the two-petalled lotus remains at the disposal of the freedom of human arbitrariness.

The intellectual initiative of the two-petalled lotus will become “compassion-filled insight” into the world when it is taken hold of by the Spirit united to the human spirit.

But when he is abandoned and forsaken, the human stands alone with human arbitrariness.

He wished publicly to declare the great suffering of His Passion. Wherefore these words: “My God, why hast Thou abandoned Me?” are not words of one who accuses, or who reproaches, or who complains, but, as I have said, they are the words of One who declares the greatness of His suffering for the best of reasons, and at the most opportune of moments.

ROBERT BELLARMINE

Day 3: I thirst Words: I thirst

Reading: John 19:28-29, Psalm 69:21

After this, Jesus knowing that all things were now accomplished, that the scripture might be fulfilled, saith, I thirst. Now there was set a vessel full of vinegar: and they filled a sponge with vinegar, and put it upon hyssop, and put it to his mouth.

They gave me also gall for my meat; and in my thirst they gave me vinegar to drink.

Chakra: Throat Chakra, the sixteen-petalled lotus flower

The sixteen-petalled lotus is the centre of the creative word.

The creative word of the sixteen-petalled lotus will become magical: it will have the faculty of illumining, consoling and healing.

That will be the result of the fulfillment of the scripture. Now, the essence of vertical respiration is the alternation between prayer and benediction or grace. These two elements of vertical respiration manifest themselves in all domains of the inner life — mind, heart and will. Thus a relevant problem for the mind, which is not due to curiosity or intellectual collectionism, but rather to the thirst for truth, is fundamentally a prayer. And the illumination by which it may be followed is the corresponding benediction or grace. True suffering, also, is fundamentally always a prayer. And the consolation, peace and joy which can follow are the effects of the benediction or grace corresponding to it.

FROM MOT

Day 4: Today shalt thou be with me in paradise **Words:** Verily I say unto thee, today shalt thou be with me in paradise

Reading: Luke 23:41-43

We receive the due reward of our deeds: but this man hath done nothing amiss. And he said unto Jesus, *Lord, remember me when thou comest into thy kingdom.* And Jesus said unto him, *Verily I say unto thee, today shalt thou be with me in paradise.*

Chakra: Heart Chakra, the twelve-petalled lotus flower

The foundation of the heart is love. The heart lives only when it loves. It is then like the sun.

Chastity is the state of the human being where the twelve-petalled lotus is awakened and becomes the sun of the microcosmic “planetary system”. The three lotus centres situated below it begin then to function in conformity with the life of the heart (the twelve-petalled lotus), i.e. “according to solar law”.

The “heart” that we have in mind here is not that of emotion and the faculty of being passionate that one generally understands by “heart”. It is the middle centre of the seven centres of man’s psychic and vital constitution. It is the “twelve-petalled lotus”. This centre is the most human of all the centres of “lotus flowers”. The twelve-petalled lotus (the heart centre) is that of love.

The “heart” is the centre or lotus of love — where, truth to tell, it is no longer a question of “above” or “outside” or even of “above” and “below”, because love abolishes all distances and all distinctions of space (even distinctions of spiritual space) and has the power to make all things present. It is thus that God is present in a heart glowing with love.

The heart or twelve-petalled lotus, gives us the certainty of authentic faith, which was born in the “fire of Emmaus”.

FROM MOTI

Each thief had a choice: “Love existence, and you have chosen heaven; hate it, and there you have chosen hell.”

The good thief was centred in the Heart.

The magic of the five wounds operates by the presence of the reality of the superhuman spiritual world by means of the wounds, and accomplishes the transmutation from the states of “limbo” and “purgatory” to the state of union with the Divine, or “paradise”.

Day 5: Father forgive them **Words:** Father, forgive them; for they know not what they do.

Reading: Luke 23:32-34

And there were also two other malefactors, led with him to be put to death. And when they were come to the place, which is called Calvary, there they crucified him, and the malefactors, one on the right hand, and the other on the left. Then said Jesus, *Father, forgive them; for they know not what they do.*

Chakra: Solar Plexus Chakra, the ten-petalled lotus flower

The ten-petalled lotus is the centre of science. Science tends to be self-contained without reference to anything transcendental. This must be forgiven.

When oriented to the heart chakra, the ten-petalled lotus will then become conscience, i.e. the servant of God and neighbor.

Day 6: Behold thy son! Behold thy mother **Words:** Woman, behold thy son! Behold thy mother.

Reading: John 19:26-27

When Jesus therefore saw his mother, and the disciple standing by, whom he loved, he saith unto his mother, *Woman, behold thy son!* Then saith he to the disciple, *Behold thy mother!* And from that hour that disciple took her unto his own home.

Chakra: Sacral Chakra, the six-petalled lotus flower

The six-petalled lotus is the centre of harmony and health.

Under the influence of the heart, the six-petalled lotus will become that of holiness, i.e. harmony between spirit, soul and body.

Day 7: It is consummated **Words:** It is consummated.

Reading: John 19:30

Jesus therefore, when he had taken the vinegar, said: *It is consummated:* and bowing his head, he gave up the ghost.

Chakra: Root Chakra, the four-petalled lotus flower

The four-petalled lotus is the centre of creative force.

Under the influence of the heart, the creative force of the four-petalled lotus will then serve as a source of energy and inexhaustible elan.

But that requires that the soul understands what it means that the great work of salvation has been accomplished. Otherwise, they live without love and repentance.

The three beasts are neutralized:

- The pig or ignorance
- The snake or malice
- The rooster or concupiscence

Then I spoke My last word: “It is finished.” Yes, it was accomplished, the great work of salvation. But how much benefit has it been for the many thousands and thousands of souls, even when, through My death and mediation, they also were delivered from the original sin (but did not follow Me in spirit and in deeds)? Heaven was opened for them, but through their sinfulness, living without love and repentance, they drew again eternal damnation to themselves.

Children of men, as My first and last word I say to you again in the full earnest of My love:

Repent. Return to your Lord and God in word and deed. Stop your usury and remember your poor brothers who beg for your mercy in vain. Remember the widows and orphans. And speak righteously to those who are immature.

For it is written: “With the measure with which you measure, so will you also be measured.” Let the fate of former generations be a warning to you. As long as they remained faithful to God

they were successful and happy, but when they began only to trust themselves God turned away from those nations, and whole kingdoms were wiped out from the face of the Earth.

Revealed to Jakob Lorber in 1863.

Posted by cologero